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CONTROLLING OPERATION OF DRUG ADMINISTRATION DEVICES USING SURGICAL HUBS

Abstract

In general, systems and methods for controlling operation of drug administration devices using surgical hubs are provided.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/068,859 entitled “Controlling Operation of Drug Administration Devices Using Surgical Hubs” filed Oct. 13, 2020, which claims priority to U.S. Prov. Application No. 63/020,940 entitled “Drug Administration Devices That Communicate With External Systems And/Or Other Devices” filed May 6, 2020, and U.S. Prov. Application No. 63/020,931 entitled “Drug Delivery Adjustment” filed May 6, 2020, which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates generally to controlling operation of drug administration devices using surgical hubs.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Pharmaceutical products (including large and small molecule pharmaceuticals, hereinafter “drugs”) are administered to patients in a variety of different ways for the treatment of specific medical indications. Regardless of the manner of the administration, care must be taken when administering drugs to avoid adverse effects on the patient. For example, care must be taken not to administer more than a safe amount of the drug to the patient. This requires consideration of the amount of dose given and the time frame over which the dose is delivered, sometimes in relation to previous doses, or doses of other drugs. Moreover, care must be taken not to inadvertently administer an incorrect drug to the patient, or drugs that have degraded due to their age or storage conditions. All of these considerations can be conveyed in guidance associated with the specific drugs or drug combinations. However, this guidance is not always followed correctly, for example due to mistakes, such as human error. This can lead to adverse effects on the patient or result in inappropriate drug administration, for example insufficient or excessive volume of drug being administered for the specific medical indication.

[0004] Patients rarely share the same medical characteristics. For example, patients generally have different ages, weights, general states of health, and medical histories. Therefore the same illness tends to affect patients differently. Thus, while guidance supplied with specific drugs may aid a medical practitioner or patient in determining a suitable dosage amount, dosage frequency, and dosage time (dosage regimen) it will not necessarily inform the medical practitioner or patient of the optimum dosage for a particular patient. In order to determine the optimum dosage, the medical practitioner or patient would have to measure some or all possible factors affecting a patient and consider how the different factors interact. This is often impossible, and so medical practitioners or patients have to make a best guess as to the optimum dosage based on information that they have observed about the patient. These best guesses will rarely result in timely administration of an optimum dosage. Moreover, because the best guess is based on data observed by the medical practitioner or patient, there is an undesirable element of subjectivity and possibility of user error

when determining or attempting to administer the best guess dosage.

[0005] In relation to how a drug is administered to the patient, there are various dosage forms that can be used. For example, these dosage forms may include parenteral, inhalational, oral, ophthalmic, topical, and suppository forms of one or more drugs.

[0006] The dosage forms can be administered directly to the patient via a drug administration device. There are a number of different types of drug administration devices commonly available for delivery of the various dosage forms including: syringes, injection devices (e.g., autoinjectors, jet injectors, and infusion pumps), and inhalers.

SUMMARY

[0007] In general, systems and methods for controlling operation of drug administration devices using surgical hubs are provided.

[0008] In one aspect, a surgical system is provided that in one embodiment includes a drug administration device, a first sensor, a memory, and a processor. The drug administration device is configured to deliver a drug to a patient during performance of a surgical procedure on the patient. The first sensor is configured to gather data, during the performance of the surgical procedure, regarding a first characteristic associated with a patient. The memory is configured to store therein an algorithm including at least one variable parameter. The processor is configured to control delivery of a first dose of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm. The processor is also configured to change, during the performance of the surgical procedure, the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory based on the data gathered by the first sensor. The processor is also configured to, after changing the at least one variable parameter, control delivery of a second dose of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm.

[0009] The surgical system can vary in any number of ways. For example, the drug administration device can include the first sensor. For another example, the first sensor can be external to and separate from the drug administration device.

[0010] For yet another example, the surgical system can also include a second sensor configured to gather data, during the performance of the surgical procedure, regarding a second, different characteristic associated with the patient, and the processor can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory also based on the data gathered by the second sensor. In at least some embodiments, the first characteristic can be a physiological characteristic of the patient, and the second characteristic can be a situational characteristic of the patient. In at least some embodiments, the processor can also be configured to consider the data gathered by each of the first and second sensors in a hierarchy in changing the at least one variable parameter. In at least some embodiments, the drug administration device can include the first sensor, the second sensor can be external to and separate from the drug administration device, a surgical hub can include the processor, and the surgical hub can be configured to be in communication with the drug administration device during the performance of the surgical procedure, thereby allowing the surgical hub to communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory.

[0011] For still another example, the drug administration device can include the processor and the memory. In at least some embodiments, the surgical system can also include a second processor, a surgical hub can include the second processor, the surgical hub can be configured to be in communication with the drug administration device during the performance of the surgical procedure, thereby allowing the surgical hub to communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory, the surgical hub can also be configured to determine using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, and based on the data gathered by the first sensor, that the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory should be changed, and the surgical hub can also

be configured to cause, using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, an instruction to be communicated to the drug administration device instructing the drug administration device to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory.

[0012] For yet another example, the drug administration device can include the memory, a surgical hub can include the processor, and the surgical hub can be configured to be in communication with the drug administration device during the performance of the surgical procedure, thereby allowing the surgical hub to communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory. In at least some embodiments, the drug administration device can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter only after the drug administration device receives the instruction.

[0013] For another example, the first characteristic can be at least one of a physiological characteristic of the patient and a situational characteristic of the patient. In at least some embodiments, the first characteristic can be at least one of blood sugar level, blood pressure, perspiration level, heart rate, core temperature, tremor detection, time of day, date, patient activity level, blood pressure, metabolic rate, altitude, temperature of the drug, viscosity of the drug, GPS information, angular rate, current of a motor used in delivering the drug, blood oxygenation level, sun exposure, osmolality, and air quality.

[0014] For yet another example, the at least one variable parameter can include a rate of delivery of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient. For still another example, the at least one variable parameter can include a time interval between dose deliveries such that doses delivered after the changing of the at least one variable parameter are at a different time interval than doses delivered before the changing of the at least one variable parameter. For another example, changing the at least one variable parameter can result in the processor controlling delivery of the second dose such that the second dose is not delivered to the patient. For still another example, the processor can be configured to automatically change the at least one variable parameter.

[0015] In another aspect, a surgical method is provided that in one embodiment includes gathering data, using a first sensor, regarding a first characteristic associated with a patient during performance of a surgical procedure on the patient. The surgical method also includes, using a processor, controlling delivery of a first dose of a drug from a drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing an algorithm stored in a memory. The surgical method also includes, using the processor, changing, during the performance of the surgical procedure, at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory based on the data gathered by the first sensor. The surgical method also includes, using the processor, after changing the at least one variable parameter, controlling delivery of a second dose from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm.

[0016] The surgical method can vary in any number of ways. For example, the surgical method can also include gathering data, using a second sensor, regarding a second, different characteristic associated with the patient, and the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory can be changed also based on the data gathered by the second sensor. For another example, the drug administration device can include the processor and the memory, the surgical method can also include a surgical hub communicating, using a second processor of the surgical hub, during the performance of the surgical procedure, an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory, the surgical method can also include the surgical hub determining, using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, and based on the data gathered by the first sensor, that the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory should be changed, and the surgical method can also include the surgical hub causing, using the second processor, during the performance of the

surgical procedure, an instruction to be communicated to the drug administration device instructing the drug administration device to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory. For yet another example, the drug administration device can include the memory, a surgical hub can include the processor, and the surgical method can also include the surgical hub communicating an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory. For still another example, the first characteristic can be at least one of a physiological characteristic of the patient and a situational characteristic of the patient.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0017] The present invention is described by way of reference to the accompanying figures which are as follows:

[0018] FIG. 1 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a first type of drug administration device, namely an autoinjector;

[0019] FIG. 2 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a second type of drug administration device, namely an infusion pump;

[0020] FIG. 3 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a third type of drug administration device, namely an inhaler;

[0021] FIG. 4 is a schematic view of a general drug administration device;

[0022] FIG. 5 is a schematic view of a universal drug administration device;

[0023] FIG. 6 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a housing for a dosage form;

[0024] FIG. 7 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a communication network system with which the drug administration devices and housing can operate;

[0025] FIG. 8 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a computer system with which the drug administration devices and housing can operate;

[0026] FIG. 9 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a computer-implemented interactive surgical system;

[0027] FIG. 10 is a schematic view of one embodiment of a surgical data network;

[0028] FIG. 11 is a schematic view of another embodiment of a drug administration device;

[0029] FIG. 12 is a flow diagram of the drug administration device of FIG. 11 in use;

[0030] FIG. 13 is a schematic view of another embodiment of a drug administration device;

[0031] FIG. 14 is a flow diagram of the drug administration device of FIG. 13 in use;

[0032] FIG. 15 is a perspective view of one embodiment of an accessory for use with a drug administration device in the form of glasses that can view a patient's food;

[0033] FIG. 16 is a perspective view of another embodiment of an accessory for use with a drug administration device in the form of a smartphone photographing a patient;

[0034] FIG. 17 is a graphical representation of the patient's skin of FIG. 16 photographed over time and measured for a reaction;

[0035] FIG. 18 is a perspective view of the accessory of FIG. 16 photographing the patient;

[0036] FIG. 19 is a graphical representation of the patient's skin of FIG. 18 photographed over time and measured for a reaction;

[0037] FIG. 20 is a graphical representation of the effects on a patient over time of another embodiment of a drug administration device in use;

[0038] FIG. 21 is a graphical representation of the effects on a patient over time of another embodiment of a drug administration device in use;

[0039] FIG. 22 is a front view of a user interface of another embodiment of a drug administration device; and

[0040] FIG. 23 is a graphical representation of the effects on a patient over time of the drug

administration device of FIG. 22 in use.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0041] Certain exemplary embodiments will now be described to provide an overall understanding of the principles of the structure, function, manufacture, and use of the devices, systems, and methods disclosed herein. One or more examples of these embodiments are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. A person skilled in the art will understand that the devices, systems, and methods specifically described herein and illustrated in the accompanying drawings are non-limiting exemplary embodiments and that the scope of the present invention is defined solely by the claims. The features illustrated or described in connection with one exemplary embodiment may be combined with the features of other embodiments. Such modifications and variations are intended to be included within the scope of the present invention.

[0042] Further, in the present disclosure, like-named components of the embodiments generally have similar features, and thus within a particular embodiment each feature of each like-named component is not necessarily fully elaborated upon. Additionally, to the extent that linear or circular dimensions are used in the description of the disclosed systems, devices, and methods, such dimensions are not intended to limit the types of shapes that can be used in conjunction with such systems, devices, and methods. A person skilled in the art will recognize that an equivalent to such linear and circular dimensions can easily be determined for any geometric shape. A person skilled in the art will appreciate that a dimension may not be a precise value but nevertheless be considered to be at about that value due to any number of factors such as manufacturing tolerances and sensitivity of measurement equipment. Sizes and shapes of the systems and devices, and the components thereof, can depend at least on the size and shape of components with which the systems and devices will be used.

[0043] Examples of various types of drug administration devices, namely: an autoinjector **100**, an infusion pump **200**, and an inhaler **300**, are described below.

Autoinjectors

[0044] FIG. **1** is a schematic exemplary view of a first type of drug delivery device (also referred to herein as a “drug administration device”), namely an injection device, in this example an autoinjector **100**, useable with embodiments described herein. The autoinjector **100** includes a drug holder **110**, which retains a drug to be dispensed, and a dispensing mechanism **120**, which is configured to dispense a drug from the drug holder **110** so that it can be administered to a patient. The drug holder **110** is typically in the form of a container which contains the drug, for example it may be provided in the form of a syringe or a vial, or be any other suitable container which can hold the drug. The autoinjector **100** includes a discharge nozzle **122**, for example a needle of a syringe, which is provided at a distal end of the drug holder **110**. The dispensing mechanism **120** includes a drive element **124**, which itself may also include a piston and/or a piston rod, and drive mechanism **126**. The dispensing mechanism **120** is located proximal to the end of the drug holder **110** and towards the proximal end of the autoinjector **100**.

[0045] The autoinjector **100** includes a housing **130** which contains the drug holder **110**, the drive element **124**, and the drive mechanism **126** within the body of the housing **130**, as well as containing the discharge nozzle **122**, which, prior to injection, would typically be contained fully within the housing **130**, but which would extend out of the housing **130** during an injection sequence to deliver the drug. The dispensing mechanism **120** is arranged so that the drive element **124** is advanced through the drug holder **110** in order to dispense the drug through the discharge nozzle **122**, thereby allowing the autoinjector **100** to administer a drug retained in drug holder **110** to a patient. In some instances, a user may advance the drive element **124** through the drug holder **110** manually. In other instances, the drive element **124** may be advanced through the drug holder **110** under control of a robotic surgical system. In other instances, the drive mechanism **126** may include a stored energy source **127** which advances the drive element **124** without user assistance. The stored energy source **127** may include a resilient biasing member such as a spring, or a

pressurized gas, or electronically powered motor and/or gearbox.

[0046] The autoinjector **100** includes a dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **140**. The dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **140** typically has two functions. Firstly, the dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **140** can function to prevent access to the discharge nozzle **122** prior to and after injection. Secondly, the autoinjector **100** can function, such that when put into an activated state, e.g., the dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **140** is moved to an unlocked position, the dispensing mechanism **120** can be activated.

[0047] The protection mechanism **140** covers at least a part of the discharge nozzle **122** when the drug holder **110** is in its retracted position proximally within the housing **130**. This is to impede contact between the discharge nozzle **122** and a user. Alternatively, or in addition, the protection mechanism **140** is itself configured to retract proximally to expose the discharge nozzle **122** so that it can be brought into contact with a patient. The protection mechanism **140** includes a shield member **141** and return spring **142**. The return spring **142** acts to extend the shield member **141** from the housing **130**, thereby covering the discharge nozzle **122** when no force is applied to the distal end of the protection mechanism **140**. If a user applies a force to the shield member **141** against the action of the return spring **142** to overcome the bias of the return spring **142** (or a robotic surgical system causes such a force to be provided to the shield member **141**), the shield member **141** retracts within the housing **130**, thereby exposing the discharge nozzle **122**. The protection mechanism **140** may alternatively, or in addition, include an extension mechanism (not shown) for extending the discharge nozzle **122** beyond the housing **130**, and may further include a retracting mechanism (not shown) for retracting the discharge nozzle **122** within the housing **130**. The protection mechanism **140** may alternatively, or in addition, include a housing cap and/or discharge nozzle boot, which can be attached to the autoinjector **100**. Removal of the housing cap would typically also remove the discharge nozzle boot from the discharge nozzle **122**.

[0048] The autoinjector **100** also includes a trigger **150**. The trigger **150** includes a trigger button **151** which is located on an external surface of the housing **130** so that it is accessible by a user of the autoinjector **100** and/or by a robotic surgical system configured to control actuation of the trigger **150**. When the trigger **150** is pressed by a user (or a robotic surgical system causes the trigger **150** to be pressed), it acts to release the drive mechanism **126** so that, via the drive element **124**, the drug is then driven out of the drug holder **110** via the discharge nozzle **122**.

[0049] The trigger **150** can also cooperate with the shield member **141** in such a way that the trigger **150** is prevented from being activated until the shield member **141** has been retracted proximally sufficiently into the housing **130** into an unlocked position, for example by pushing a distal end of the shield member **141** against the skin of a patient. When this has been done, the trigger **150** becomes unlocked, and the autoinjector **100** is activated such that the trigger **150** can be depressed and the injection and/or drug delivery sequence is then initiated. Alternatively, retraction of the shield member **141** alone in a proximal direction into the housing **130** can act to activate the drive mechanism **126** and initiate the injection and/or drug delivery sequence. In this way, the autoinjector **100** has device operation prevention mechanism which prevents dispensing of the drug by, for example, preventing accidental release of the dispensing mechanism **120** and/or accidental actuation of the trigger **150**.

[0050] While the foregoing description relates to one example of an autoinjector, this example is presented purely for illustration, the present invention is not limited solely to such an autoinjector. A person skilled in the art understands that various modifications to the described autoinjector can be implemented within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0051] Autoinjectors of the present disclosure can be used to administer any of a variety of drugs, such as any of epinephrine, Rebif, Enbrel, Aranesp, atropine, pralidoxime chloride, and diazepam. Infusion Pumps

[0052] Patients can require precise, continuous delivery of medication or medication delivery on a regular or frequent basis at set periodic intervals. Infusion pumps can provide such controlled drug

infusion by facilitating the administering of the drug at a precise rate that keeps the drug concentration within a therapeutic margin, without requiring frequent attention by a healthcare professional or the patient.

[0053] FIG. 2 is a schematic exemplary view of a second type of drug delivery device, namely an infusion pump **200**, useable with the embodiments described herein. The infusion pump **200** includes a drug holder **210** (also referred to herein as a “reservoir”) in the form of a reservoir for containing a drug to be delivered, and a dispensing mechanism **220** including a pump **216** configured to dispense a drug contained in the reservoir, so that the drug can be delivered to a patient. These components of the infusion pump **200** are located within a housing **230**. The dispensing mechanism **220** further includes an infusion line **212**. The drug is delivered from the reservoir **210** upon actuation of the pump **216** via the infusion line **212**, which can take the form of a cannula. The pump **216** can take the form of an elastomeric pump, a peristaltic pump, an osmotic pump, or a motor-controlled piston in a syringe. Typically, the drug is delivered intravenously, although subcutaneous, arterial and epidural infusions can also be used.

[0054] Infusion pumps of the present disclosure can be used to administer any of a variety of drugs, such as any of insulin, antropline sulfate, avibactam sodium, bendamustine hydrochloride, carboplatin, daptomycin, epinephrine, levetiracetam, oxaliplatin, paclitaxel, pantoprazole sodium, treprostinil, vasopressin, voriconazole, and zoledronic acid.

[0055] The infusion pump **200** further includes control circuitry, for example a processor **296** in addition to a memory **297** and a user interface **280**, which together provide a triggering mechanism and/or dosage selector for the pump **200**. The user interface **280** can be implemented by a display screen located on the housing **230** of the infusion pump **200**. The control circuitry and user interface **280** can be located within the housing **230** or external thereto and can communicate via a wired or wireless interface with the pump **216** to control its operation.

[0056] Actuation of the pump **216** is controlled by the processor **296**, which is in communication with the pump **216** for controlling the pump's operation. The processor **296** can be programmed by a user (e.g., patient or healthcare professional) via a user interface **280** and/or can be programmed electronically using a computer system (e.g., using a robotic surgical system configured to control operation of the pump **216**). This enables the infusion pump **200** to deliver the drug to a patient in a controlled manner. The user (or computer system) can enter parameters, such as infusion duration and delivery rate. The delivery rate can be set to a constant infusion rate or as set intervals for periodic delivery, typically within pre-programmed limits. The programmed parameters for controlling the pump **216** are stored in and retrieved from the memory **297** which is in communication with the processor **296**. The user interface **280** can take the form of a touch screen or a keypad.

[0057] A power supply **295** provides power to the pump **216** and can take the form of an energy source which is integral to the pump **216** and/or a mechanism for connecting the pump **216** to an external source of power.

[0058] The infusion pump **200** can take on a variety of different physical forms depending on its designated use. It can be a stationary, non-portable device, e.g., for use at a patient's bedside, in an operating room, etc., or it can be an ambulatory infusion pump which is designed to be portable or wearable. An integral power supply **295** is particularly beneficial for ambulatory infusion pumps.

[0059] While the foregoing description relates to one example of an infusion pump, this example is provided purely for illustration. The present disclosure is not limited to such an infusion pump. A person skilled in the art understands that various modifications to the described infusion pump can be implemented within the scope of the present disclosure. For example, the processor may be pre-programmed, such that it is not necessary for the infusion pump to include a user interface.

Inhalers

[0060] FIG. 3 is a schematic view of a third type of drug administration device, namely an inhaler **300**. Inhaler **300** includes a drug holder **310** in the form of a canister. The drug holder **310** contains

a drug that would typically be in solution or suspension with a suitable carrier liquid. The inhaler **300** further includes a dispensing mechanism **320**, which includes a pressurized gas for pressurizing the drug holder **310**, a valve **325** and nozzle **321**. The valve **325** forms an outlet of the drug holder **310**. The valve **325** includes a narrow opening **324** formed in the drug holder **310** and a movable element **326** that controls the opening **324**. When the movable element **326** is in a resting position, the valve **325** is in a closed or unactuated state in which the opening **324** is closed and the drug holder **310** is sealed. When the movable element **326** is actuated from the resting position to an actuated position, the valve **325** is actuated into an open state in which the opening **324** is open. Actuation of the movable element **326** from the resting position to the actuated position comprises moving the movable element **326** into the drug holder **310**. The movable element **326** is resiliently biased into the resting position. In the open state of the valve **325**, the pressurized gas propels the drug in solution or suspension with the suitable liquid out of the drug holder **310** through the opening **324** at high speed. The high speed passage of the liquid through the narrow opening **324** causes the liquid to be atomized, that is, to transform from a bulk liquid into a mist of fine droplets of liquid and/or into a gas cloud. A patient may inhale the mist of fine droplets and/or the gas cloud into a respiratory passage. Hence, the inhaler **300** is capable of delivering a drug retained within the drug holder **310** into a respiratory passage of a patient.

[0061] The drug holder **310** is removably held within a housing **330** of the inhaler **300**. A passage **333** formed in the housing **330** connects a first opening **331** in the housing **330** and a second opening **332** in the housing **330**. The drug holder **310** is received within the passage **333**. The drug holder **310** is slidably insertable through the first opening **331** of the housing **330** into the passage **333**. The second opening **332** of the housing **330** forms a mouthpiece **322** configured to be placed in a patient's mouth or a nosepiece configured to be placed in a patient's nostril, or a mask configured to be placed over the patient's mouth and nose. The drug holder **310**, the first opening **331** and the passage **333** are sized such that air can flow through the passage **333**, around the drug holder **310**, between the first opening **331** and the second opening **332**. The inhaler **300** can be provided with a dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **140** in the form of a cap (not shown) which can be fitted to the mouthpiece **322**.

[0062] Inhaler **300** further includes a trigger **350** including a valve actuation feature **355** configured to actuate the valve **325** when the trigger **350** is activated. The valve actuation feature **355** is a projection of the housing **330** into the passage **333**. The drug holder **310** is slidably movable within the passage **333** from a first position into a second position. In the first position, an end of the movable element **326** in the resting position abuts the valve actuation feature **355**. In the second position, the drug holder **310** can be displaced towards the valve actuation feature **355** such that the valve actuation feature **355** moves the movable element **326** into the drug holder **310** to actuate the valve **325** into the open state. The user's hand (or other element handheld by a user or controlled by a robotic surgical system) provides the necessary force to move the drug holder **310** from the first position to the second position against the resiliently biased movable element **326**. The valve actuation feature **355** includes an inlet **356**, which is connected to the nozzle **321**. The inlet **356** of the valve actuation feature **355** is sized and positioned to couple to the opening **324** of the valve **325** such that the ejected mist of droplets and/or gas cloud can enter the inlet **356** and exit from the nozzle **321** into the passage **333**. The nozzle **321** assists in the atomization of the bulk liquid into the mist of droplets and/or gas cloud.

[0063] The valve **325** provides a metering mechanism **370**. The metering mechanism **370** is configured to close the valve after a measured amount of liquid, and therefore, drug, has passed through the opening **324**. This allows a controlled dose to be administered to the patient. Typically, the measured amount of liquid is pre-set, however, the inhaler **300** can be equipped with a dosage selector **360** that is operable by a user and/or electronically by a computer system to change the defined amount of liquid.

[0064] While the foregoing description relates to one particular example of an inhaler, this example

is purely illustrative. The description should not be seen as limited only to such an inhaler. A person skilled in the art understands that numerous other types of inhalers and nebulizers may be used with the present disclosure. For example, the drug can be in a powdered form, the drug can be in liquid form, or the drug can be atomized by other forms of dispensing mechanism **320** including ultrasonic vibration, compressed gas, a vibrating mesh, or a heat source.

[0065] The inhalers of the present disclosure can be used to administer any of a variety of drugs, such as any of mometasone, fluticasone, ciclesonide, budesonide, beclomethasone, vilanterol, salmeterol, formoterol, umeclidinium, glycopyrrolate, tiotropium, aclidinium, indacaterol, salmeterol, and olodaterol.

Drug Administration Devices

[0066] As will be appreciated from the foregoing, various components of drug delivery devices are common to all such devices. These components form the essential components of a universal drug administration device. A drug administration device delivers a drug to a patient, where the drug is provided in a defined dosage form within the drug administration device.

[0067] FIG. **4** is a generalized schematic view of such a universal drug administration device **501**, and FIG. **5** is an exemplary embodiment of such a universal drug administration device **500**.

Examples of the universal drug administration device **500** include injection devices (e.g., autoinjectors, jet injectors, and infusion pumps), nasal spray devices, and inhalers.

[0068] As shown in FIG. **4**, the drug administration device **501** includes in general form the features of a drug holder **10** and a dispensing mechanism **20**. The drug holder **10** holds a drug in a dosage form to be administered. The dispensing mechanism **20** is configured to release the dosage form from the drug holder **10** so that the drug can be administered to a patient.

[0069] FIG. **5** shows a further universal drug administration device **500** which includes a number of additional features. A person skilled in the art understands that these additional features are optional for different embodiments and can be utilized in a variety of different combinations such that the additional features may be present or may be omitted from a given embodiment of a particular drug administration device, depending upon requirements, such as the type of drug, dosage form of the drug, medical indication being treated with the drug, safety requirements, whether the device is powered, whether the device is portable, whether the device is used for self-administration, and many other requirements which will be appreciated by a person skilled in the art. Similar to the universal device of FIG. **4**, the drug administration device **500** of FIG. **5** includes a housing **30** which accommodates the drug holder **10** and dispensing mechanism **20**.

[0070] The device **500** is provided with a triggering mechanism **50** for initiating the release of the drug from the drug holder **10** by the dispensing mechanism **20**. The device **500** includes the feature of a metering/dosing mechanism **70** which measures out a set dose to be released from the drug holder **10** via the dispensing mechanism **20**. In this manner, the drug administration device **500** can provide a known dose of determined size. The device **500** includes a dosage selector **60** which enables a user to set the dose volume of drug to be measured out by the metering mechanism **50**. The dose volume can be set to one specific value of a plurality of predefined discrete dose volumes, or any value of predefined dose volume within a range of dose volumes.

[0071] The device **500** includes a device operation prevention mechanism **40** or **25** which when in a locked state will prevent and/or stop the dispensing mechanism **20** from releasing the drug out of the drug holder **10**, and when in an unlocked state will permit the dispensing mechanism **20** to release the drug dosage from out of the drug holder **10**. This can prevent accidental administration of the drug, for example to prevent dosing at an incorrect time, or for preventing inadvertent actuation. The device **500** also includes a dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **42** which prevents access to at least a part of the dispensing mechanism **20**, for example for safety reasons. The device operation prevention mechanism **40** and the dispensing mechanism protection mechanism **42** can be the same component.

[0072] The device **500** includes a device indicator **85** which is configured to present information

about the status of the drug administration device and/or the drug contained therein. The device indicator **85** can be a visual indicator, such as a display screen, or an audio indicator. The device **500** includes a user interface **80** which can be configured to present a user of the device **500** with information about the device **500** and/or to enable the user to control the device **500**. The device **500** includes a device sensor **92** which is configured to sense information relating to the drug administration device and/or the drug contained therein, for example dosage form and device parameters. As an example, in embodiments which include a metering mechanism **70** and a dosage selector **60**, the embodiment can further include one or more device sensors **92** configured to sense one or more of: the dose selected by a user using dosage selector **60**, the dose metered by the metering mechanism **70** and the dose dispensed by the dispensing mechanism **20**. Similarly, an environment sensor **94** is provided which is configured to sense information relating to the environment in which the device **500** is present, such as the temperature of the environment, the humidity of the environment, location, and time. There can be a dedicated location sensor **98** which is configured to determine the geographical location of the device **500**, e.g., via satellite position determination, such as GPS. The device **500** also includes a communications interface **99** which can communicate externally data which has been acquired from the various sensors about the device and/or drug.

[0073] If required, the device **500** includes a power supply **95** for delivering electrical power to one or more electrical components of the device **500**. The power supply **95** can be a source of power which is integral to device **500** and/or a mechanism for connecting device **500** to an external source of power. The drug administration device **500** also includes a computer system **90** including a processor **96** and a memory **97** powered by the power supply **95** and in communication with each other, and optionally with other electrical and control components of the device **500**, such as the environment sensor **94**, the location sensor **98**, the device sensor **92**, the communications interface **99**, and/or the indicator **85**. The processor **96** is configured to obtain data acquired from the environment sensor **94**, the device sensor **92**, the communications interface **99**, the location sensor **98**, and/or the user interface **80** and process it to provide data output, for example to indicator **85** and/or to communications interface **99**.

[0074] In some embodiments, the drug administration device **500** is enclosed in packaging **35**. The packaging **35** can further include a combination of a processor **96**, a memory **97**, a user interface **80**, a device indicator **85**, a device sensor **92**, a location sensor **98**, and/or environment sensors **94** as described herein, and these can be located externally on the housing of the device **500**.

[0075] A person skilled in the art will appreciate that the universal drug administration device **500** including the drug holder **10** and the dispensing mechanism **20** can be provided with a variety of the optional features described above, in a number of different combinations. Moreover, the drug administration device **500** can include more than one drug holder **10**, optionally with more than one dispensing mechanism **20**, such that each drug holder **10** has its own associated dispensing mechanism **20**.

Drug Dosage Forms

[0076] Conventionally, drug administration devices utilize a liquid dosage form. It will be appreciated by a person skilled in the art, however, that other dosage forms are available.

[0077] One such common dosage form is a tablet. The tablet may be formed from a combination of the drug and an excipient that are compressed together. Other dosage forms are pastes, creams, powders, ear drops, and eye drops.

[0078] Further examples of drug dosage forms include dermal patches, drug eluting stents and intrauterine devices. In these examples, the body of the device includes the drug and can be configured to allow the release of the drug under certain circumstances. For example, a dermal patch may include a polymeric composition containing the drug. The polymeric composition allows the drug to diffuse out of the polymeric composition and into skin of a patient. Drug eluting stents and intrauterine devices can operate in an analogous manner. In this way, the patches, stents,

and intrauterine devices can themselves be considered drug holders with an associated dispensing mechanism.

[0079] Any of these dosage forms can be configured to have the drug release initiated by certain conditions. This can allow the drug to be released at a desired time or location after the dosage form has been introduced into the patient. In particular, the drug release can be initiated by an external stimulus. Moreover, these dosage forms can be contained prior to administration in a housing, which can be in the form of packaging. This housing can contain some of the optional features described above which are utilized with the universal drug administration device **500**.

[0080] The drug administered by the drug administration devices of the present disclosure can be any substance that causes a change in an organism's physiology or psychology when consumed. Examples of drugs that the drug administration devices of the present disclosure can administer include 5-alpha-reductase inhibitors, 5-aminosalicylates, 5HT3 receptor antagonists, ACE inhibitors with calcium channel blocking agents, ACE inhibitors with thiazides, adamantane antivirals, adrenal cortical steroids, adrenal corticosteroid inhibitors, adrenergic bronchodilators, agents for hypertensive emergencies, agents for pulmonary hypertension, aldosterone receptor antagonists, alkylating agents, allergenics, alpha-glucosidase inhibitors, alternative medicines, amebicides, aminoglycosides, aminopenicillins, aminosalicylates, AMPA receptor antagonists, amylin analogs, analgesic combinations, analgesics, androgens and anabolic steroids, Angiotensin Converting Enzyme Inhibitors, angiotensin II inhibitors with calcium channel blockers, angiotensin II inhibitors with thiazides, angiotensin receptor blockers, angiotensin receptor blockers and neprilysin inhibitors, anorectal preparations, anorexiant, antacids, anthelmintics, anti-angiogenic ophthalmic agents, anti-CTLA-4 monoclonal antibodies, anti-infectives, anti-PD-1 monoclonal antibodies, antiadrenergic agents (central) with thiazides, antiadrenergic agents (peripheral) with thiazides, antiadrenergic agents, centrally acting, antiadrenergic agents, peripherally acting, antiandrogens, antianginal agents, antiarrhythmic agents, antiasthmatic combinations, antibiotics/antineoplastics, anticholinergic antiemetics, anticholinergic antiparkinson agents, anticholinergic bronchodilators, anticholinergic chronotropic agents, anticholinergics/antispasmodics, anticoagulant reversal agents, anticoagulants, anticonvulsants, antidepressants, antidiabetic agents, antidiabetic combinations, antidiarrheals, antidiuretic hormones, antidotes, antiemetic/antivertigo agents, antifungals, antigonadotropic agents, antigout agents, antihistamines, antihyperlipidemic agents, antihyperlipidemic combinations, antihypertensive combinations, antihyperuricemic agents, antimalarial agents, antimalarial combinations, antimalarial quinolones, antimanic agents, antimetabolites, antimigraine agents, antineoplastic combinations, antineoplastic detoxifying agents, antineoplastic interferons, antineoplastics, antiparkinson agents, antiplatelet agents, antipseudomonal penicillins, antipsoriatics, antipsychotics, antirheumatics, antiseptic and germicides, antithyroid agents, antitoxins and antivenoms, antituberculosis agents, antituberculosis combinations, antitussives, antiviral agents, antiviral boosters, antiviral combinations, antiviral interferons, anxiolytics, sedatives, and hypnotics, aromatase inhibitors, atypical antipsychotics, azole antifungals, bacterial vaccines, barbiturate anticonvulsants, barbiturates, BCR-ABL tyrosine kinase inhibitors, benzodiazepine anticonvulsants, benzodiazepines, beta blockers with calcium channel blockers, beta blockers with thiazides, beta-adrenergic blocking agents, beta-lactamase inhibitors, bile acid sequestrants, biologicals, bisphosphonates, bone morphogenetic proteins, bone resorption inhibitors, bronchodilator combinations, bronchodilators, calcimimetics, calcineurin inhibitors, calcitonin, calcium channel blocking agents, carbamate anticonvulsants, carbapenems, carbapenems/beta-lactamase inhibitors, carbonic anhydrase inhibitor anticonvulsants, carbonic anhydrase inhibitors, cardiac stressing agents, cardioselective beta blockers, cardiovascular agents, catecholamines, cation exchange resins, CD20 monoclonal antibodies, CD30 monoclonal antibodies, CD33 monoclonal antibodies, CD38 monoclonal antibodies, CD52 monoclonal antibodies, CDK 4/6 inhibitors, central nervous system agents, cephalosporins,

cephalosporins/beta-lactamase inhibitors, cerumenolytics, CFTR combinations, CFTR potentiators, CGRP inhibitors, chelating agents, chemokine receptor antagonist, chloride channel activators, cholesterol absorption inhibitors, cholinergic agonists, cholinergic muscle stimulants, cholinesterase inhibitors, CNS stimulants, coagulation modifiers, colony stimulating factors, contraceptives, corticotropin, coumarins and indandiones, cox-2 inhibitors, decongestants, dermatological agents, diagnostic radiopharmaceuticals, diarylquinolines, dibenzazepine anticonvulsants, digestive enzymes, dipeptidyl peptidase 4 inhibitors, diuretics, dopaminergic antiparkinsonism agents, drugs used in alcohol dependence, echinocandins, EGFR inhibitors, estrogen receptor antagonists, estrogens, expectorants, factor Xa inhibitors, fatty acid derivative anticonvulsants, fibric acid derivatives, first generation cephalosporins, fourth generation cephalosporins, functional bowel disorder agents, gallstone solubilizing agents, gamma-aminobutyric acid analogs, gamma-aminobutyric acid reuptake inhibitors, gastrointestinal agents, general anesthetics, genitourinary tract agents, GI stimulants, glucocorticoids, glucose elevating agents, glycopeptide antibiotics, glycoprotein platelet inhibitors, glycyclines, gonadotropin releasing hormones, gonadotropin-releasing hormone antagonists, gonadotropins, group I antiarrhythmics, group II antiarrhythmics, group III antiarrhythmics, group IV antiarrhythmics, group V antiarrhythmics, growth hormone receptor blockers, growth hormones, guanylate cyclase-C agonists, H. pylori eradication agents, H2 antagonists, hedgehog pathway inhibitors, hematopoietic stem cell mobilizer, heparin antagonists, heparins, HER2 inhibitors, herbal products, histone deacetylase inhibitors, hormones, hormones/antineoplastics, hydantoin anticonvulsants, hydrazide derivatives, illicit (street) drugs, immune globulins, immunologic agents, immunostimulants, immunosuppressive agents, impotence agents, in vivo diagnostic biologicals, incretin mimetics, inhaled anti-infectives, inhaled corticosteroids, inotropic agents, insulin, insulin-like growth factors, integrase strand transfer inhibitor, interferons, interleukin inhibitors, interleukins, intravenous nutritional products, iodinated contrast media, ionic iodinated contrast media, iron products, ketolides, laxatives, leprostatics, leukotriene modifiers, lincomycin derivatives, local injectable anesthetics, local injectable anesthetics with corticosteroids, loop diuretics, lung surfactants, lymphatic staining agents, lysosomal enzymes, macrolide derivatives, macrolides, magnetic resonance imaging contrast media, mast cell stabilizers, medical gas, meglitinides, metabolic agents, methylxanthines, mineralocorticoids, minerals and electrolytes, miscellaneous agents, miscellaneous analgesics, miscellaneous antibiotics, miscellaneous anticonvulsants, miscellaneous antidepressants, miscellaneous antidiabetic agents, miscellaneous antiemetics, miscellaneous antifungals, miscellaneous antihyperlipidemic agents, miscellaneous antihypertensive combinations, miscellaneous antimalarials, miscellaneous antineoplastics, miscellaneous antiparkinson agents, miscellaneous antipsychotic agents, miscellaneous antituberculosis agents, miscellaneous antivirals, miscellaneous anxiolytics, sedatives and hypnotics, miscellaneous bone resorption inhibitors, miscellaneous cardiovascular agents, miscellaneous central nervous system agents, miscellaneous coagulation modifiers, miscellaneous diagnostic dyes, miscellaneous diuretics, miscellaneous genitourinary tract agents, miscellaneous GI agents, miscellaneous hormones, miscellaneous metabolic agents, miscellaneous ophthalmic agents, miscellaneous otic agents, miscellaneous respiratory agents, miscellaneous sex hormones, miscellaneous topical agents, miscellaneous uncategorized agents, miscellaneous vaginal agents, mitotic inhibitors, monoamine oxidase inhibitors, mouth and throat products, mTOR inhibitors, mucolytics, multikinase inhibitors, muscle relaxants, mydriatics, narcotic analgesic combinations, narcotic analgesics, nasal anti-infectives, nasal antihistamines and decongestants, nasal lubricants and irrigations, nasal preparations, nasal steroids, natural penicillins, neprilysin inhibitors, neuraminidase inhibitors, neuromuscular blocking agents, neuronal potassium channel openers, next generation cephalosporins, nicotinic acid derivatives, NK1 receptor antagonists, NNRTIs, non-cardioselective beta blockers, non-iodinated contrast media, non-ionic iodinated contrast media, non-sulfonylureas, Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, NS5A inhibitors, nucleoside reverse

transcriptase inhibitors (NRTIs), nutraceutical products, nutritional products, ophthalmic anesthetics, ophthalmic anti-infectives, ophthalmic anti-inflammatory agents, ophthalmic antihistamines and decongestants, ophthalmic diagnostic agents, ophthalmic glaucoma agents, ophthalmic lubricants and irrigations, ophthalmic preparations, ophthalmic steroids, ophthalmic steroids with anti-infectives, ophthalmic surgical agents, oral nutritional supplements, other immunostimulants, other immunosuppressants, otic anesthetics, otic anti-infectives, otic preparations, otic steroids, otic steroids with anti-infectives, oxazolidinone anticonvulsants, oxazolidinone antibiotics, parathyroid hormone and analogs, PARP inhibitors, PCSK9 inhibitors, penicillinase resistant penicillins, penicillins, peripheral opioid receptor antagonists, peripheral opioid receptor mixed agonists/antagonists, peripheral vasodilators, peripherally acting antiobesity agents, phenothiazine antiemetics, phenothiazine antipsychotics, phenylpiperazine antidepressants, phosphate binders, PI3K inhibitors, plasma expanders, platelet aggregation inhibitors, platelet-stimulating agents, polyenes, potassium sparing diuretics with thiazides, potassium-sparing diuretics, probiotics, progesterone receptor modulators, progestins, prolactin inhibitors, prostaglandin D2 antagonists, protease inhibitors, protease-activated receptor-1 antagonists, proteasome inhibitors, proton pump inhibitors, psoralens, psychotherapeutic agents, psychotherapeutic combinations, purine nucleosides, pyrrolidine anticonvulsants, quinolones, radiocontrast agents, radiologic adjuncts, radiologic agents, radiologic conjugating agents, radiopharmaceuticals, recombinant human erythropoietins, renin inhibitors, respiratory agents, respiratory inhalant products, rifamycin derivatives, salicylates, sclerosing agents, second generation cephalosporins, selective estrogen receptor modulators, selective immunosuppressants, selective phosphodiesterase-4 inhibitors, selective serotonin reuptake inhibitors, serotonin-norepinephrine reuptake inhibitors, serotonergic neuroenteric modulators, sex hormone combinations, sex hormones, SGLT-2 inhibitors, skeletal muscle relaxant combinations, skeletal muscle relaxants, smoking cessation agents, somatostatin and somatostatin analogs, spermicides, statins, sterile irrigating solutions, streptogramins, streptomyces derivatives, succinimide anticonvulsants, sulfonamides, sulfonylureas, synthetic ovulation stimulants, tetracyclic antidepressants, tetracyclines, therapeutic radiopharmaceuticals, therapeutic vaccines, thiazide diuretics, thiazolidinediones, thioxanthenes, third generation cephalosporins, thrombin inhibitors, thrombolytics, thyroid drugs, TNF alfa inhibitors, tocolytic agents, topical acne agents, topical agents, topical allergy diagnostic agents, topical anesthetics, topical anti-infectives, topical anti-rosacea agents, topical antibiotics, topical antifungals, topical antihistamines, topical antineoplastics, topical antipsoriatics, topical antivirals, topical astringents, topical debriding agents, topical depigmenting agents, topical emollients, topical keratolytics, topical non-steroidal anti-inflammatoirepical photochemotherapeutics, topical rubefacient, topical steroids, topical steroids with anti-infectives, transthyretin stabilizers, triazine anticonvulsants, tricyclic antidepressants, trifunctional monoclonal antibodies, ultrasound contrast media, upper respiratory combinations, urea anticonvulsants, urea cycle disorder agents, urinary anti-infectives, urinary antispasmodics, urinary pH modifiers, uterotonic agents, vaccine combinations, vaginal anti-infectives, vaginal preparations, vasodilators, vasopressin antagonists, vasopressors, VEGF/VEGFR inhibitors, viral vaccines, viscosupplementation agents, vitamin and mineral combinations, vitamins, or VMAT2 inhibitors. The drug administration devices of the present disclosure may administer a drug selected from epinephrine, Rebif, Enbrel, Aranesp, atropine, pralidoxime chloride, diazepam, insulin, antroprine sulfate, avibactam sodium, bendamustine hydrochloride, carboplatin, daptomycin, epinephrine, levetiracetam, oxaliplatin, paclitaxel, pantoprazole sodium, treprostinil, vasopressin, voriconazole, zoledronic acid, mometasone, fluticasone, ciclesonide, budesonide, beclomethasone, vilanterol, salmeterol, formoterol, umecclidinium, glycopyrrolate, tiotropium, aclidinium, indacaterol, salmeterol, and olodaterol. [0081] As mentioned above, any of a variety of drugs can be delivered using a drug administration device.

Drug Housings

[0082] As described above, a dosage form can be provided in a holder that is appropriate for the particular dosage form being utilized. For example, a drug in a liquid dosage form can be held prior to administration within a holder in the form of a vial with a stopper, or a syringe with a plunger. A drug in solid or powder dosage form, e.g., as tablets, can be contained in a housing which is arranged to hold the tablets securely prior to administration.

[0083] The housing can include one or a plurality of drug holders, where each holder contains a dosage form, e.g., the drug can be in a tablet dosage form and the housing can be in the form of a blister pack, where a tablet is held within each of a plurality of holders. The holders being in the form of recesses in the blister pack.

[0084] FIG. 6 depicts a housing **630** that includes a plurality of drug holders **610** that each contain a dosage form **611**. The housing **630** can have at least one environment sensor **94**, which is configured to sense information relating to the environment in which the housing **630** is present, such as the temperature of the environment, time or location. The housing **630** can include at least one device sensor **92**, which is configured to sense information relating to the drug of the dosage form **611** contained within the holder **610**. There can be a dedicated location sensor **98** which is configured to determine the geographical location of the housing **630**, e.g., via satellite position determination, such as GPS.

[0085] The housing **630** can include an indicator **85** which is configured to present information about the status of the drug of the dosage form **611** contained within the holder **610** to a user of the drug housing. The housing **630** can also include a communications interface **99** which can communicate information externally via a wired or wireless transfer of data pertaining to the drug housing **630**, environment, time, or location and/or the drug itself.

[0086] If required, the housing **630** can include a power supply **95** for delivering electrical power to one or more electrical components of the housing **630**. The power supply **95** can be a source of power which is integral to housing **630** and/or a mechanism for connecting the housing **630** to an external source of power. The housing **630** can also include a computer system **90** including a processor **96** and a memory **97** powered by the power supply **95** and in communication with each other, and optionally with other electrical and control components of the housing **630**, such as the environment sensor **94**, the location sensor **98**, the device sensor **92**, the communications interface **99**, and/or the indicator **85**. The processor **96** is configured to obtain data acquired from the environment sensor **94**, the device sensor **92**, the communications interface **99**, the location sensor **98**, and/or the user interface **80** and process it to provide data output, for example to the indicator **85** and/or to the communications interface **99**.

[0087] The housing **630** can be in the form of packaging. Alternatively, additional packaging can be present to contain and surround the housing **630**.

[0088] The holder **610** or the additional packaging the themselves include one or more of the device sensor **92**, the environment sensor **94**, the indicator **85**, the communications interface **99**, the power supply **95**, location sensor **98**, and the computer system including the processor **96** and the memory **85**, as described above.

Electronic Communication

[0089] As mentioned above, the communications interface **99** can be associated with the drug administration device **500** or the drug housing **630**, by being included within or on the housing **30**, **630**, or alternatively within or on the packaging **35**. Such a communications interface **99** can be configured to communicate with a remote computer system, such as central computer system **700** shown in FIG. 7. As shown in FIG. 7, the communications interface **99** associated with the drug administration device **500** or the housing **630** is configured to communicate with a central computer system **700** through a communications network **702** from any number of locations such as a medical facility **706** (e.g., a hospital or other medical care center), a home base **708** (e.g., a patient's home or office or a care taker's home or office), or a mobile location **710**. The

communications interface **99** can be configured to access the system **700** through a wired and/or wireless connection to the network **702**. In an exemplary embodiment, the communications interface **99** of FIG. **6** is configured to access the system **700** wirelessly, e.g., through Wi-Fi connection(s), which can facilitate accessibility of the system **700** from almost any location in the world.

[0090] A person skilled in the art will appreciate that the system **700** can include security features such that the aspects of the system **700** available to any particular user can be determined based on, e.g., the identity of the user and/or the location from which the user is accessing the system. To that end, each user can have a unique username, password, biometric data, and/or other security credentials to facilitate access to the system **700**. The received security parameter information can be checked against a database of authorized users to determine whether the user is authorized and to what extent the user is permitted to interact with the system, view information stored in the system, and so forth.

Computer Systems

[0091] As discussed herein, one or more aspects or features of the subject matter described herein, for example components of the central computer system **700**, the processor **96**, the power supply **95**, the memory **97**, the communications interface **99**, the user interface **80**, the device indicators **85**, the device sensors **92**, the environment sensors **94**, and the location sensors **98**, can be realized in digital electronic circuitry, integrated circuitry, specially designed application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) computer hardware, firmware, software, and/or combinations thereof. These various aspects or features can include implementation in one or more computer programs that are executable and/or interpretable on a programmable system including at least one programmable processor, which can be special or general purpose, coupled to receive data and instructions from, and to transmit data and instructions to, a storage system, at least one input device, and at least one output device. The programmable system or computer system can include clients and servers. A client and server are generally remote from each other and typically interact through a communications network, e.g., the Internet, a wireless wide area network, a local area network, a wide area network, or a wired network. The relationship of client and server arises by virtue of computer programs running on the respective computers and having a client-server relationship to each other.

[0092] The computer programs, which can also be referred to as programs, software, software applications, applications, components, or code, include machine instructions for a programmable processor, and can be implemented in a high-level procedural language, an object-oriented programming language, a functional programming language, a logical programming language, and/or in assembly/machine language. As used herein, the term “machine-readable medium” refers to any computer program product, apparatus and/or device, such as for example magnetic discs, optical disks, memory, and Programmable Logic Devices (PLDs), used to provide machine instructions and/or data to a programmable processor, including a machine-readable medium that receives machine instructions as a machine-readable signal. The term “machine-readable signal” as used herein refers to any signal used to provide machine instructions and/or data to a programmable processor. The machine-readable medium can store such machine instructions non-transitorily, such as for example as would a non-transient solid-state memory or a magnetic hard drive or any equivalent storage medium. The machine-readable medium can alternatively or additionally store such machine instructions in a transient manner, such as for example as would a processor cache or other random access memory associated with one or more physical processor cores.

[0093] To provide for interaction with a user, one or more aspects or features of the subject matter described herein, for example the user interface **80** (which can be integrated or separate to the administration device **500** or the housing **630**), can be implemented on a computer having a display screen, such as for example a cathode ray tube (CRT) or a liquid crystal display (LCD) or a light

emitting diode (LED) monitor for displaying information to the user. The display screen can allow input thereto directly (e.g., as a touch screen) or indirectly (e.g., via an input device such as a keypad or voice recognition hardware and software). Other kinds of devices can be used to provide for interaction with a user as well. For example, feedback provided to the user can be any form of sensory feedback, such as for example visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback; and input from the user may be received in any form, including, but not limited to, acoustic, speech, or tactile input. As described above, this feedback may be provided via one or more device indicators **85** in addition to the user interface **80**. The device indicators **85** can interact with one or more of the device sensor(s) **92**, the environment sensor(s) **94**, and/or the location sensor(s) **98** in order to provide this feedback, or to receive input from the user.

[0094] FIG. **8** illustrates one exemplary embodiment of the computer system **700**, depicted as computer system **800**. The computer system includes one or more processors **896** configured to control the operation of the computer system **800**. The processor(s) **896** can include any type of microprocessor or central processing unit (CPU), including programmable general-purpose or special-purpose microprocessors and/or any one of a variety of proprietary or commercially available single or multi-processor systems. The computer system **800** also includes one or more memories **897** configured to provide temporary storage for code to be executed by the processor(s) **896** or for data acquired from one or more users, storage devices, and/or databases. The memory **897** can include read-only memory (ROM), flash memory, one or more varieties of random access memory (RAM) (e.g., static RAM (SRAM), dynamic RAM (DRAM), or synchronous DRAM (SDRAM)), and/or a combination of memory technologies.

[0095] The various elements of the computer system are coupled to a bus system **812**. The illustrated bus system **812** is an abstraction that represents any one or more separate physical busses, communication lines/interfaces, and/or multi-drop or point-to-point connections, connected by appropriate bridges, adapters, and/or controllers. The computer system **800** also includes one or more network interface(s) **899** (also referred to herein as a communications interface), one or more input/output (IO) interface(s) **880**, and one or more storage device(s) **810**.

[0096] The communications interface(s) **899** are configured to enable the computer system to communicate with remote devices, e.g., other computer systems and/or devices **500** or housings **630**, over a network, and can be, for example, remote desktop connection interfaces, Ethernet adapters, and/or other local area network (LAN) adapters. The IO interface(s) **880** include one or more interface components to connect the computer system **800** with other electronic equipment. For example, the IO interface(s) **880** can include high speed data ports, such as universal serial bus (USB) ports, 1394 ports, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, etc. Additionally, the computer system **800** can be accessible to a human user, and thus the IO interface(s) **880** can include displays, speakers, keyboards, pointing devices, and/or various other video, audio, or alphanumeric interfaces. The storage device(s) **810** include any conventional medium for storing data in a non-volatile and/or non-transient manner. The storage device(s) **810** are thus configured to hold data and/or instructions in a persistent state in which the value(s) are retained despite interruption of power to the computer system. The storage device(s) **810** can include one or more hard disk drives, flash drives, USB drives, optical drives, various media cards, diskettes, compact discs, and/or any combination thereof and can be directly connected to the computer system or remotely connected thereto, such as over a network. In an exemplary embodiment, the storage device(s) **810** include a tangible or non-transitory computer readable medium configured to store data, e.g., a hard disk drive, a flash drive, a USB drive, an optical drive, a media card, a diskette, or a compact disc.

[0097] The elements illustrated in FIG. **8** can be some or all of the elements of a single physical machine. In addition, not all of the illustrated elements need to be located on or in the same physical machine.

[0098] The computer system **800** can include a web browser for retrieving web pages or other markup language streams, presenting those pages and/or streams (visually, aurally, or otherwise),

executing scripts, controls and other code on those pages/streams, accepting user input with respect to those pages/streams (e.g., for purposes of completing input fields), issuing HyperText Transfer Protocol (HTTP) requests with respect to those pages/streams or otherwise (e.g., for submitting to a server information from the completed input fields), and so forth. The web pages or other markup language can be in HyperText Markup Language (HTML) or other conventional forms, including embedded Extensible Markup Language (XML), scripts, controls, and so forth. The computer system **800** can also include a web server for generating and/or delivering the web pages to client computer systems.

[0099] As shown in FIG. 7, the computer system **800** of FIG. 8 as described above may form the components of the central computer system **700** which is in communication with one or more of the device computer systems **90** of the one or more individual drug administration devices **500** or housings **630** and/or in communication with one or more other elements, such as one or more surgical instruments. Data, such as operational data of the devices **500** or housings **630**, medical data acquired of patients by such devices **500** or housings **630**, operational data of the surgical instruments, medical data acquired of patients by such surgical instruments, can be exchanged between the central and device computer systems **700**, **90**.

[0100] As mentioned the computer system **800** as described above can also form the components of a device computer system **90** which is integrated into or in close proximity to the drug administration device **500** or housing **630**. In this regard, the one or more processors **896** correspond to the processor **96**, the network interface **799** corresponds to the communications interface **99**, the IO interface **880** corresponds to the user interface **80**, and the memory **897** corresponds to the memory **97**. Moreover, the additional storage **810** can also be present in device computer system **90**.

[0101] In an exemplary embodiment, the computer system **800** can form the device computer system **90** as a single unit, e.g., contained within a single drug administration device housing **30**, contained within a single package **35** for one or more drug administration devices **500**, or a housing **630** that includes a plurality of drug holders **610**. The computer system **800** can form the central computer system **700** as a single unit, as a single server, or as a single tower.

[0102] The single unit can be modular such that various aspects thereof can be swapped in and out as needed for, e.g., upgrade, replacement, maintenance, etc., without interrupting functionality of any other aspects of the system. The single unit can thus also be scalable with the ability to be added to as additional modules and/or additional functionality of existing modules are desired and/or improved upon.

[0103] The computer system can also include any of a variety of other software and/or hardware components, including by way of example, operating systems and database management systems. Although an exemplary computer system is depicted and described herein, it will be appreciated by a person skilled in the art that this is for sake of generality and convenience. In other embodiments, the computer system may differ in architecture and operation from that shown and described here. For example, the memory **897** and the storage device **810** can be integrated together, or the communications interface **899** can be omitted if communication with another computer system is not necessary.

Surgical Hubs

[0104] In an exemplary embodiment, the computer system to which data regarding drug administration devices and/or surgical instruments is communicated includes a surgical hub. Exemplary examples of surgical hubs configured to receive, analyze, and output data, and methods of using such surgical hubs, are further described in U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0200844 entitled "Method Of Hub Communication, Processing, Storage And Display" filed Dec. 4, 2018 U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201046 entitled "Method For Controlling Smart Energy Devices" filed Dec. 4, 2018, and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201114 entitled "Adaptive Control Program Updates For Surgical Hubs" filed Mar. 29, 2018, which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

[0105] In general, a surgical hub can be a component of a comprehensive digital medical system capable of spanning multiple medical facilities and configured to provide integrated and comprehensive improved medical care to a vast number of patients. The comprehensive digital medical system includes a cloud-based medical analytics system that is configured to interconnect to multiple surgical hubs located across many different medical facilities. The surgical hubs are configured to interconnect with one or more elements, such as one or more surgical instruments that are used to conduct medical procedures on patients and/or one or more drug administration device that are used to administer one or more drugs to patients during performance of medical procedures. The surgical hubs provide a wide array of functionality to improve the outcomes of medical procedures. The data generated by the various surgical devices, drug administration devices, and surgical hubs about the patient and the medical procedure may be transmitted to the cloud-based medical analytics system. This data may then be aggregated with similar data gathered from many other surgical hubs, drug administration devices, and surgical instruments located at other medical facilities. Various patterns and correlations may be found through the cloud-based analytics system analyzing the collected data. Improvements in the techniques used to generate the data may be generated as a result, and these improvements may then be disseminated to the various surgical hubs, drug administration devices, and surgical instruments. Due to the interconnectedness of all of the aforementioned components, improvements in medical procedures and practices may be found that otherwise may not be found if the many components were not so interconnected. Various examples of structures and functions of these various components are described in more detail in previously mentioned U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0200844 entitled “Method Of Hub Communication, Processing, Storage And Display” filed Dec. 4, 2018 and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201046 entitled “Method For Controlling Smart Energy Devices” filed Dec. 4, 2018.

[0106] FIG. 9 illustrates an embodiment of a computer-implemented interactive surgical system **1000** that includes one or more surgical systems **1002** and a cloud-based system (e.g., a cloud **1004** that can include a remote server **1013** coupled to a storage device **1005**). Each surgical system **1002** includes at least one surgical hub **1006** in communication with the cloud **1004**. In one example, as illustrated in FIG. 9, the surgical system **1002** includes a visualization system **1008**, a robotic system **1010**, a handheld intelligent surgical instrument **1012**, and a drug delivery device **1014**, which are configured to communicate with one another and/or the hub **1006**. The surgical system **1002** can include an M number of hubs **1006**, an N number of visualization systems **1008**, an O number of robotic systems **1010**, a P number of handheld intelligent surgical instruments **1012**, and a Q number of drug delivery devices **1014**, where M, N, O, P, and Q are integers greater than or equal to one that may or may not be equal to any one or more of each other. Various exemplary drug delivery devices are described above. Various exemplary examples of suitable robotic systems, visualization systems, cloud-based analytics, and surgical instruments that can be used in a computer-implemented interactive surgical system are further described in previously mentioned U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0200844 entitled “Method Of Hub Communication, Processing, Storage And Display” filed Dec. 4, 2018, U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201046 entitled “Method For Controlling Smart Energy Devices” filed Dec. 4, 2018, and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201114 entitled “Adaptive Control Program Updates For Surgical Hubs” filed Mar. 29, 2018.

[0107] FIG. 10 illustrates one example of a surgical data network **1101** including a modular communication hub **1103**, e.g., the hub **1006**, configured to connect modular devices located in one or more operating theaters of a healthcare facility, or any room in a healthcare facility specially equipped for surgical operations, to a cloud-based system including the cloud **1104** that includes a remote server coupled to a storage device, e.g., the cloud **1004** that includes the remote server coupled to the storage device **1005**. The modular communication hub **1103** includes a network hub **1107** and/or a network switch **1109** in communication with a network router **1111**. The network hub **1107**, the network switch **1109**, and the network router **1111** define the communication hub's communications interface. The modular communication hub **1103** also can be coupled to a local

computer system **1110** to provide local computer processing and data manipulation. The surgical data network **1101** can be configured as passive, intelligent, or switching. A passive surgical data network serves as a conduit for the data, enabling it to go from one device (or segment) to another and to the cloud computing resources. An intelligent surgical data network includes additional features to enable the traffic passing through the surgical data network to be monitored and to configure each port in the network hub **1107** or network switch **1109**. An “intelligent surgical data network” may be referred to as a “manageable hub” or “manageable switch.” A switching hub reads the destination address of each packet and then forwards the packet to the correct port.

[0108] Modular devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n**, e.g., any number of surgical instruments such as instruments **1012** and/or any number of drug delivery devices such as devices **1014**, located in the operating theater can be coupled to the modular communication hub **1103**. The network hub **1107** and/or the network switch **1109** can be coupled to a network router **1111** to connect the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n** to the cloud **1104** or the local computer system **1110**. Data associated with the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n** can be transferred to cloud-based computers via the router for remote data processing and manipulation. Data associated with the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n** can also be transferred to the local computer system **1110** for local data processing and manipulation. Modular devices **2.sub.a-2.sub.m** located in the same operating theater also can be coupled to a network switch **1109**. The network switch **1109** can be coupled to the network hub **1107** and/or the network router **1111** to connect to the devices **2.sub.a-2.sub.m** to the cloud **1104**. Data associated with the devices **2.sub.a-2.sub.m** can be transferred to the cloud **1104** via the network router **1111** for data processing and manipulation. Data associated with the devices **2.sub.a-2.sub.m** can also be transferred to the local computer system **1110** for local data processing and manipulation. The numbers *n*, *m* of the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** can be the same as or different from one another.

[0109] A person skilled in the art will appreciate that the surgical data network **1101** can be expanded by interconnecting multiple network hubs **1107** and/or multiple network switches **1109** with multiple network routers **1111**. The modular communication hub **1103** can be contained in a modular control tower configured to receive multiple devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m**. The local computer system **1110** also can be contained in a modular control tower. The modular communication hub **1103** is connected to a display **1112** to display images obtained by at least some of the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m**, for example during surgical procedures.

[0110] The surgical data network **1101** can include a combination of network hub(s), network switch(es), and network router(s) connecting the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** to the cloud **1104**. Any one of or all of the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** coupled to the network hub **1107** or network switch **1109** can collect data in real time and transfer the data to cloud computers for data processing and manipulation. Alternatively or in addition, any one or all of the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** coupled to the network hub **1107** or network switch **1109** can transfer previously collected data, such as sensor data, to cloud computers for data processing and manipulation, e.g., once the one or all of the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** is operatively connected to the cloud **1104** via the communication hub **1103**. A person skilled in the art will appreciate that cloud computing relies on sharing computing resources rather than having local servers or personal devices to handle software applications. The term “cloud” can be used as a metaphor for “the Internet,” although the term is not limited as such. Accordingly, the term “cloud computing” may be used herein to refer to “a type of Internet-based computing,” where different services, such as servers, storage, and applications, are delivered to the modular communication hub **1103** and/or the computer system **1110** located in the surgical theater (e.g., a fixed, mobile, temporary, or field operating room or space) and to devices connected to the modular communication hub **1103** and/or the computer system **1110** through the Internet. The cloud infrastructure can be maintained by a cloud service provider. In this context, the cloud service provider can be the entity that coordinates the usage and control of the devices **1.sub.a-**

1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m located in one or more operating theaters. The cloud computing services can perform a large number of calculations based on the data gathered by smart surgical instruments, smart drug delivery devices, robots, and other computerized devices located in the operating theater. The hub hardware enables multiple devices or connections to be connected to a computer that communicates with the cloud computing resources and storage.

[0111] Applying cloud computer data processing techniques on the data collected by the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, the surgical data network may provide improved surgical outcomes, reduced costs, and/or improved patient satisfaction. At least some of the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, e.g., one or more of the surgical instruments **1012**, can be employed to view tissue states to assess leaks or perfusion of sealed tissue after a tissue sealing and cutting procedure. At least some of the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, e.g., one or more of the surgical instruments **1012**, can be employed to identify pathology, such as the effects of diseases, using the cloud-based computing to examine data including images of samples of body tissue for diagnostic purposes. This includes localization and margin confirmation of tissue and phenotypes. At least some of the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, e.g., one or more of the surgical instruments **1012**, can be employed to identify anatomical structures of the body using a variety of sensors integrated with imaging devices and techniques such as overlaying images captured by multiple imaging devices. At least some of the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, e.g., one or more of the drug delivery devices **1014**, can be employed to identify dimensions of a patient's bariatric sleeve in bariatric surgical intervention using, e.g., an insulin pump, to facilitate visualization of the sleeve. The data gathered by the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m, including image data, can be transferred to the cloud **1104** or the local computer system **1110** or both for data processing and manipulation including image processing and manipulation. The data can be analyzed to improve surgical procedure outcomes by determining if further treatment, such as the application of endoscopic intervention, emerging technologies, a targeted radiation, targeted intervention, precise robotics to tissue-specific sites and conditions, and drug administration may be pursued. Such data analysis can further employ outcome analytics processing, and using standardized approaches may provide beneficial feedback to either confirm surgical treatments and the behavior of the surgeon or suggest modifications to surgical treatments, surgeon behavior, drug delivery devices, and/or drugs.

[0112] The operating theater devices la-In can be connected to the modular communication hub **1103** over a wired channel or a wireless channel depending on the configuration of the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n to a network hub. The network hub **1107** can be implemented as a local network broadcast device that works on the physical layer of the Open System Interconnection (OSI) model. The network hub provides connectivity to the devices 1.sub.a-1.sub.n located in the same operating theater network. The network hub **1107** collects data in the form of packets and sends them to the router **1111** in half duplex mode. The network hub **1107** does not store any media access control/Internet Protocol (MAC/IP) to transfer the device data. Only one of the devices la-In can send data at a time through the network hub **1107**. The network hub **1107** has no routing tables or intelligence regarding where to send information and broadcasts all network data across each connection and to a remote server over the cloud **1104**. The network hub **1107** can detect basic network errors such as collisions, but having all information broadcast to multiple ports can be a security risk and cause bottlenecks.

[0113] The operating theater devices 2.sub.a-2.sub.m can be connected to a network switch **1109** over a wired channel or a wireless channel. The network switch **1109** works in the data link layer of the OSI model. The network switch **1109** is a multicast device for connecting the devices 2.sub.a-2.sub.m located in the same operating theater to the network. The network switch **1109** sends data in the form of frames to the network router **1111** and works in full duplex mode. Multiple devices 2.sub.a-2.sub.m can send data at the same time through the network switch **1109**. The network switch **1109** stores and uses MAC addresses of the devices 2.sub.a-2.sub.m to transfer data.

[0114] The network hub **1107** and/or the network switch **1109** are coupled to the network router **1111** for connection to the cloud **1104**. The network router **1111** works in the network layer of the OSI model. The network router **1111** creates a route for transmitting data packets received from the network hub **1107** and/or the network switch **1111** to cloud-based computer resources for further processing and manipulation of the data collected by any one of or all the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m**. The network router **1111** can be employed to connect two or more different networks located in different locations, such as, for example, different operating theaters of the same healthcare facility or different networks located in different operating theaters of different healthcare facilities. The network router **1111** sends data in the form of packets to the cloud **1104** and works in full duplex mode. Multiple devices can send data at the same time. The network router **1111** uses IP addresses to transfer data.

[0115] In one example, the network hub **1107** can be implemented as a USB hub, which allows multiple USB devices to be connected to a host computer. The USB hub can expand a single USB port into several tiers so that there are more ports available to connect devices to the host system computer. The network hub **1107** can include wired or wireless capabilities to receive information over a wired channel or a wireless channel. A wireless USB short-range, high-bandwidth wireless radio communication protocol can be employed for communication between the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n** and devices **2.sub.a-2.sub.m** located in the operating theater.

[0116] In other examples, the operating theater devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** can communicate to the modular communication hub **1103** via Bluetooth wireless technology standard for exchanging data over short distances (using short-wavelength UHF radio waves in the ISM band from 2.4 to 2.485 GHz) from fixed and mobile devices and building personal area networks (PANs). In other aspects, the operating theater devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** can communicate to the modular communication hub **1103** via a number of wireless or wired communication standards or protocols, including but not limited to Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family), WiMAX (IEEE 802.16 family), IEEE 802.20, long-term evolution (LTE), and Ev-DO, HSPA+, HSDPA+, HSUPA+, EDGE, GSM, GPRS, CDMA, TDMA, DECT, and Ethernet derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless and wired protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, 5G, and beyond. The computing module can include a plurality of communication modules. For example, a first communication module may be dedicated to shorter-range wireless communications such as Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, and a second communication module can be dedicated to longer-range wireless communications such as GPS, EDGE, GPRS, CDMA, WiMAX, LTE, Ev-DO, and others.

[0117] The modular communication hub **1103** can serve as a central connection for one or all of the operating theater devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m** and handle a data type known as frames. Frames carry the data generated by the devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m**. When a frame is received by the modular communication hub **1103**, it is amplified and transmitted to the network router **1111**, which transfers the data to the cloud computing resources by using a number of wireless or wired communication standards or protocols, as described herein.

[0118] The modular communication hub **1103** can be used as a standalone device or be connected to compatible network hubs and network switches to form a larger network. The modular communication hub **1103** is generally easy to install, configure, and maintain, making it a good option for networking the operating theater devices **1.sub.a-1.sub.n/2.sub.a-2.sub.m**.

[0119] Data received by a surgical hub regarding drug administration devices and regarding patients can be used in any of a variety of ways. In an exemplary embodiment, the surgical hub can receive data from drug administration devices and/or one or more sensors in use with a patient in a surgical setting, e.g., in use in an operating room during performance of a surgical procedure. The surgical hub can use the received data in any of one or more ways, as discussed further below.

[0120] The surgical hub can be configured to analyze the received data in real time with use of the drug administration devices and adjust control one or more of the drug administration devices and/or one or more surgical instruments in use with the patient based on the analysis of the

received data. Such adjustment can include, for example, causing more of a drug previously delivered to the patient in the surgical setting to be delivered to the patient by one or more of the drug delivery devices, causing a drug not previously delivered to the patient in the surgical setting to be delivered to the patient by one or more of the drug delivery devices, adjusting one or operational control parameters of at the one or more surgical instruments, causing one or more sensors of one or more of the drug administration devices and/or of one or more surgical instruments to take a measurement to help gain an understanding of the patient's current physiological condition, current operational status of a drug administration device, and/or current operational status of a surgical instrument, and other adjustments. Controlling and adjusting operation of drug administration devices is discussed further below. Examples of the operational control parameters include motor speed, cutting element speed, time, duration, and level of energy application. Controlling and adjusting operation of surgical instruments is described further in previously mentioned U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0200844 entitled "Method Of Hub Communication, Processing, Storage And Display" filed Dec. 4, 2018, U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201046 entitled "Method For Controlling Smart Energy Devices" filed Dec. 4, 2018, and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0201114 entitled "Adaptive Control Program Updates For Surgical Hubs" filed Mar. 29, 2018, and in U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0207857 entitled "Surgical Network Determination Of Prioritization Of Communication, Interaction, Or Processing Based On System Or Device Needs" filed Nov. 6, 2018 and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2019/0206555 entitled "Cloud-based Medical Analytics For Customization And Recommendations To A User" filed Mar. 29, 2018, which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

[0121] The surgical hub can be configured to cause visualization of the received data to be provided in the surgical setting on a display so that medical professionals in the surgical setting can view the data and thereby receive an understanding of the operation of the drug administration device(s) in use in the surgical setting. Such information provided via visualization can include text and/or images indicating when any of the drug administration device(s) administered a drug to the patient, identifying which drug(s) have been administered to the patient by any of the drug administration device(s), indicating whether any of the drug administration device(s) encountered an error in attempting to deliver a drug to the patient, and other types of information.

Operating Drug Administration Devices

[0122] When delivering drugs using any of the drug delivery devices discussed above or any other drug delivery device, a variety of factors can influence drug administration, absorption, and effect on a patient beyond simply the initial drug dose itself. For example, individual patient physiologies or statuses, physiological effects on a patient of drug administration, surrounding external conditions to the patient, etc. can all influence results of drug administration on a patient. It can thus be beneficial to a patient to allow drug delivery to be adjusted based on a variety of different factors that arise during use of drug administration devices, providing more personalized treatment while also helping a patient receive and/or a doctor deliver specialized care for the specific patient being treated. Additionally, being able to automate as much of the drug delivery adjustment can help ease the process of delivery for both the patient and the doctor, while improving patient outcomes. In a surgical setting in which the drug administration device is being used during performance of a surgical procedure, being able to automate as much of the drug delivery adjustment can help ease the process of delivery for the surgeon and/or other medical personnel and free time for the surgeon and/or other medical personnel to focus on surgical tasks other than drug delivery adjustment, while improving patient outcomes.

[0123] In at least some implementations, drug delivery can be altered based on one or more characteristics associated with the patient that are determined based on situational awareness of the patient. In an exemplary embodiment, at least one sensor is configured to gather data regarding a characteristic associated with the patient. In embodiments including multiple sensors, each of the sensors can be configured to gather data regarding a different characteristic associated with the

patient. In some embodiments, a drug administration device includes at least first and second sensors that are each configured to gather data regarding a different characteristic associated with a patient. In some embodiments, at least one sensor external to and separate from a drug administration device is configured to gather data regarding a characteristic associated with a patient. The at least one external, separate sensor can be, for example, a sensor of a surgical instrument or other device in use in a same surgical procedure as the drug administration device. In some embodiments, a drug administration device includes at least first and second sensors that are each configured to gather data regarding a different characteristic associated with a patient, and at least one sensor external to and separate from the drug administration device is configured to gather data regarding a characteristic associated with a patient that can be the same as one of the characteristics associated with one of the first and second sensors or can be a different characteristic than the characteristics associated with one of the first and second sensors.

[0124] An algorithm stored on the drug administration device, e.g., in a memory thereof, is executable on board the drug administration device, e.g., by a processor thereof, to administer a dose of a drug to a patient. In some embodiments, instead of or in addition to being stored on the drug administration device, the algorithm can be stored on a surgical hub, e.g., in a memory thereof, that is configured to communicate with the drug administration device.

[0125] The algorithm is stored in the form of one or more sets of pluralities of data points defining and/or representing instructions, notifications, signals, etc. to control functions of the device and administration of the drug. Data gathered by at least one sensor is used, e.g., by the drug administration device's processor, to change at least one variable parameter of the algorithm. As discussed above, a surgical hub can be in communication with a drug administration device, so data gathered by the drug administration device and by at least one external, separate sensor in communication with the surgical hub can be communicated to the surgical hub and communicated from the surgical hub to the drug administration device. Alternatively, or in addition, the data gathered by at least one sensor can be used by the surgical hub, e.g., by the drug administration device's processor, to change at least one variable parameter of the algorithm, and the surgical hub can communicate the changed at least one variable, alone or as part of the algorithm, to the drug administration device and/or the surgical hub can communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable as determined by the surgical hub using the gathered by the at least one sensor.

[0126] The at least one variable parameter is among the algorithm's data points, e.g., are included in instructions for drug delivery, and are thus each able to be changed by changing one or more of the stored pluralities of data points of the algorithm. After the at least one variable parameter has been changed, subsequent execution of the algorithm administers another dose of the drug according to the changed algorithm. As such, drug delivery over time can be managed for a patient to increase the beneficial results of the drug by taking into consideration actual situations of the patient and actual results of the patient receiving doses of the drug. Changing the at least one variable parameter and/or administration of the one or more doses themselves is automated to improve patient outcomes. Thus, the drug administration device can be configured to provide personalized medicine based on the patient and the patient's surrounding conditions to provide a smart system for drug delivery. In a surgical setting in which the drug administration device is being used during performance of a surgical procedure, automated changing of the at least one variable parameter and/or administration of the one or more doses may allow for drug administration to be controlled based on data gathered during the performance of the surgical procedure, which may help the patient receive a drug quickly in response to a sensed or determined condition and/or may help ensure that a drug is delivered to the patient on schedule per the patient's pre-operative plan.

[0127] Using the universal drug administration device **500** of FIG. **5** by way of example, the memory **97** can have stored therein the algorithm, and the processor **96** can be configured to

execute the algorithm to control delivery of a dose of the drug dispensed by the dispensing mechanism **20**. The processor **96** can also be configured to use data gathered by at least two of the one or more device sensors **92**, environment sensor **94**, and location sensor **98** (in addition to or instead of at least one external, separate sensor) to change at least one variable parameter of the algorithm such that a dose delivered subsequent to the changing of the at least one variable parameter will be controlled by execution of the changed algorithm. As mentioned above, a person skilled in the art will appreciate that the universal drug administration device **500** can be provided with a variety of the optional features described above, in a number of different combinations, e.g., not include any of the sensors **92**, **94**, **98** not being used by the processor **96** to change variable parameter(s) of the algorithm (and instead include sensor(s) to gather the needed situational awareness data), not include packaging **35**, not include user interface **80**, etc.

[0128] FIG. **11** illustrates one embodiment of a universal drug administration device **1016** configured to alter drug delivery to a patient based on one or more various characteristics associated with the patient that are determined based on situational awareness of the patient, such as during performance of a surgical procedure. The drug administration device **1016** in this illustrated embodiment includes a housing **1018**, a drug holder **1022**, a dispensing mechanism **1020**, sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045**, a memory **1050** storing an algorithm **1052** therein that includes at least one variable parameter, a processor **1060**, a user interface **1080**, an indicator **1085**, a power supply **1095**, and a communications interface **1099**. The sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** can each be configured to measure a different parameter, as discussed herein. Additionally, similar to that mentioned above regarding the universal drug administration device **500** of FIG. **5**, a person skilled in the art will appreciate that the universal drug administration device **1016** of FIG. **11** including the drug holder **1022**, the dispensing mechanism **1020**, the processor **1060**, the memory **1050**, and the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** can be provided with a variety of the features described above, in a number of different combinations. For example, the device **1016** may include at least two sensors but not all of the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045**, may not include any of the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** with any sensor functionality being provided by at least one external, separate sensor, may not have a user interface **1080**, etc.

[0129] The first, second, and third sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** are each housed either within the housing **1018** or on an exterior surface of the housing **1018**, and each sensor **1030**, **1040**, **1045** is configured to gather data regarding a characteristic associated with the patient. The sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** can each include a device sensor (similar to device sensor **92** discussed above), an environment sensor (similar to environment sensor **94** discussed above), or a location sensor (similar to location sensor **98** discussed above). Each of the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** is configured to gathers data for a different characteristic. The characteristics can be physiological characteristics and/or situational characteristics of the patient. Various different physiological characteristics can be monitored, such as blood sugar level (e.g., using a glucose monitor, etc.), blood pressure (e.g., using a blood pressure monitor, etc.), perspiration level (e.g., using a fluid sensor, etc.), heart rate (e.g., using a heart rate monitor, etc.), etc. Furthermore, a number of different situational characteristics can be monitored, such as core temperature, (e.g., using a temperature sensor), tremor detection (using an accelerometer, etc.), time of day (e.g., using a timer, etc.), date (e.g., using a timer, etc.), patient activity level (e.g., using a motion sensor, etc.), blood pressure (e.g., using a blood pressure monitor, etc.), metabolic rate (e.g., using heart rate as discussed herein, etc.), altitude (e.g., using an altimeter, etc.), temperature of the drug (e.g., using a temperature sensor), viscosity of the drug (e.g., using a viscometer, etc.), GPS information (e.g., using a location sensor, etc.), weather information (e.g., using a temperature sensor, humidity sensor, etc.), room or external temperature (e.g., using a temperature sensor), angular rate (e.g., using an inertial measurement unit (IMU) or MARG (magnetic, angular rate, and gravity) sensor), body orientation (e.g., using an IMU, etc.), current of a motor used in delivering the drug (e.g., using a current sensor), blood oxygenation level (e.g., using a blood oxygen sensor), sun exposure (e.g., using a UV sensor, etc.),

osmolality (e.g., using a blood monitor, etc.), and air quality (e.g., using a UV sensor, etc.), inflammatory response, one or more images and/or videos of the patient and/or an environment in which the patient is located (for example, to analyze food intake; to determine whether solid food or liquid is being consumed; to determine a location or activity of the patient; to determine a condition of the patient such as skin reaction, breathing, eye dilation, voice characteristics such as tone and pitch; etc.), user-input data such as general well-being, pain score, or a cycle time between flare ups of a particular ailment, etc. In an exemplary embodiment, one sensor **1030, 1040, 1045** is configured to monitor either a physiological or a situational characteristic and the others of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** are configured to monitor the other of physiological or situational characteristics. In another exemplary embodiment, each of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** is configured to monitor a different physiological characteristic. In another exemplary embodiment, each of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** is configured to monitor a different situational characteristic. [0130] While three sensors are illustrated in FIG. **11**, the device **1016** can include only one sensor, can include only two sensors, or can include more than three sensors. Any additional sensors can be configured similarly to sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** and be configured to monitor different characteristics than the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** and from each other. In embodiments additionally or alternatively including at least one external, separate sensor, the at least one external, separate sensor can be configured similar to that discussed above regarding the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045**. [0131] The memory **1050** of the drug administration device **1016** is located in the housing **1018**. In this illustrated embodiment, the memory **1050** is configured to store data from the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045**, however in other embodiments this data can be stored elsewhere, such as in another memory on board the drug administration device **1016** and/or in a remote memory, e.g., a surgical hub's memory, a cloud server's memory, or other memory, accessible to the drug administration device **1016** via the communications interface **1099**. The algorithm **1052** stored in the memory **1050** represents instructions for the drug administration device **1016** regarding how to administer the drug in the drug holder **1022** and is configured to be executed by the processor **1060**. The algorithm **1052** is stored in the form of a plurality of data points defining and/or representing instructions, notifications, signals, etc. to control drug administration, with the at least one variable parameter being among the data points such that changing the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** results in at least one change in how the drug is administered. The at least one variable parameter can be any of a variety of different delivery and/or drug parameters. Examples of variable parameters include a rate of delivery of the drug from the drug holder **1022** to the patient, a time interval between dose deliveries such that doses delivered after the at least one variable parameter is changed are at a different time interval than doses delivered before the change, a dosage amount, a dosage concentration, whether or not any additional doses are delivered such as stopping a second or any subsequent dose or starting to dose again after dosing was previously stopped, etc.

[0132] The processor **1060** is configured to receive and analyze data from the one or more sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** and to execute the algorithm **1052** to control administration of one or more doses of the drug to the patient. In an exemplary embodiment, the processor **1060** executes the algorithm **1052** to control delivery of at least a first dose of the drug to the patient, changes the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** based on data gathered by the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045**, and executes the algorithm **1052** after changing the at least one variable parameter to control delivery of at least one subsequent dose of the drug. To execute the algorithm **1052**, the processor **1060** is configured to run a program stored in the memory **1050** to access the plurality of data points of the algorithm **1052** in the memory **1050**. To change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052**, the processor **1060** is configured to modify or update the data point(s) of the at least one variable parameter in the memory **1050**. The processor **1060** can also be configured to execute instructions stored in the memory **1050** to control the device **1016** generally, including other electrical components thereof such as the communications interface **1099**, the indicator **1085**,

and the user interface **1080**. The processor **1060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** during the delivery of a dose such that the algorithm **1052** is changed in real time with the delivery of the dose (e.g., in real time with execution of the algorithm) and/or in real time with use of the drug administration device **1016** during performance of a surgical procedure, which may accommodate real time sensed conditions. The processor **1060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** before a start of the delivery of the dose, which may consume less memory and use fewer processing resources during algorithm **1052** execution than real time changing of the algorithm **1052** during algorithm execution. As discussed above, instead of or in addition to using data from the one or more sensors **1030, 1040, 1045**, data from at least one external, separate sensor can be used.

[0133] The processor **1060** can be configured to automatically control delivery of doses of the drug based on one or more predetermined schedules or intervals of dosing for the patient, which can be predetermined prior to an initial dose or can be determined during use of the drug administration device **1016** after delivery of the first dose and set such that future doses can be based on the predetermined schedule(s). The predetermined schedule(s) can also be determined by a surgeon or other doctor, or other care provider, created automatically based on the algorithm **1052** and/or the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor) being used, or some combination thereof.

[0134] The processor **1060** can be configured to cause a notification to be provided to the patient and/or the doctor or other care provider based on gathered data from one or more of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor), for example via the device indicator **1085**, user interface **1080**, and/or communications interface **1099**. Additionally or alternatively, a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** can be configured to cause a notification to be provided to the surgeon and/or other surgical personnel based on gathered data from one or more of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor), for example via a display of the surgical hub.

[0135] Because the processor **1060** is configured to alter the at least one variable parameter based on data gathered by one or more of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or by at least one external, separate sensor), an automated reaction response based on the situational awareness of the patient is possible. In at least some embodiments, the at least one variable parameter is altered to provide adaptive dose adjustment based on various readings and/or data from one or more of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor) and/or user inputs. For example, a user can record a cycle time between flare ups of a disease or ailment, at which point the drug dosing schedule as reflected in the algorithm **1052** can be adjusted by the processor **1060** and/or remotely by a doctor or other care provider to take this into account for better disease control. As another example, changes in altitude of a patient can potentially alter the effectiveness of medications and even lead to toxicity in some cases. As such, the duration at which a patient is at a different altitude can be read by one or more of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** and be used by the processor **1060** and/or a doctor or other care provider to adjust subsequent drug dosages by the processor **1060** changing the at least one variable parameter. In another example, a treatment can be discontinued entirely based on one or more sensor readings. The treatment can be discontinued, in some instances, during performance of a surgical procedure of a patient. A patient, a surgeon or other doctor, and/or other(s) can be informed of treatment discontinuation, e.g., through the device indicator **1085**, through the user interface **1080**, via a display of a surgical hub, via a speaker of a surgical hub, etc. One or more possible complications can be anticipated based on best practices and/or on analysis performed by a surgical hub and/or a cloud server, and the processor **1060** and the memory **1050** can operate together to provide various digital ready reactions to common complications (identified through situational awareness) to alert the patient, attempt to change a behavior of the patient, notify the doctor, etc. In various embodiments, at least one of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor) includes a camera, and the

processor **1060** is configured to analyze image(s) and/or video(s) captured by the camera, such as to analyze any food intake and/or patient skin reaction to the drug.

[0136] The device indicator **1085** and/or the user interface **1080** can be configured to operate independently of each other or configured to operate together to provide various notifications to the patient and/or a doctor or other care provider of any outputs of situational awareness based on sensor readings and any complications those readings could indicate. As such, a patient and/or medical personnel may be able to react quickly to any negative results of administration of the drug and/or complications as a result of treatment. In at least some embodiments the drug administration device **1016** can be configured to provide activities the patient can pursue to best manage their condition, such as by providing suggested activities via the user interface **1080**. Furthermore, information of situational awareness based on sensor readings and any complications those readings could indicate can be relayed to the patient's doctor or other care provider, who can then communicate with the patient as needed.

[0137] Basic operations on the drug administration device **1016** itself can inform the patient and/or medical personnel of any detected deviation from the so-called “five rights” of drug administration in at least some embodiments. During drug administration, best practices require ensuring that the “five rights” of medication use are followed: the right patient, the right drug, the right time, the right dose, and the right route. Tracking situational awareness of the patient through use of the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** (and/or at least one external, separate sensor) can thus detect if any of the “five rights” are violated, at which point the patient and/or a doctor or other care provider can be informed. Furthermore, in some embodiments, confirmation of the “five rights” can be required, either by a doctor or off-site medical personnel or by the patient themselves, to help eliminate medication errors. In severe cases, a notification can be provided to the patient and/or the doctor or other care provider that immediate medical attention is needed.

[0138] The communications interface **1099** can be configured to allow one-way communication, such as providing data to a remote server (e.g., a cloud server or other server) and/or to a local, surgical hub server, and/or receiving instructions or commands from a remote server and/or a local, surgical hub server, or two-way communication, such as providing information, messages, data, etc. regarding the drug administration device **1016** and/or data stored thereon and receiving instructions, such as from a doctor, a remote server regarding updates to software, a local, surgical hub server regarding updates to software, etc. As such, doctor/care provider interaction is possible to provide additional adjustments to care. For example, doctors or other care providers can receive relevant information and data from the drug administration device **1016** via the communications interface **1099**, via a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016**, and/or from the patient directly and can, based on the received information, provide remote or local feedback and/or any adjustment(s) to the drug administration device **1016** (for example, requesting that the processor **1060** change the at least one variable parameters to change subsequent dosing) and/or to the patient (for example, providing recommended next steps based on current sensor readings and feedback from the patient). In at least some embodiments any recording or data of an incident and the data leading up to and resulting from the incident can be provided to the doctor and/or remote-care individuals, a local, surgical hub server, and/or a remote server for storage, and the receiving party can analyze and summarize the data to determine a recommendation regarding overcoming or effectively addressing any current complication. In at least some embodiments, the processor **1060** is configured to change the variable parameter only after communicating with a remote server and/or a local, surgical hub server and receiving any instructions therefrom.

[0139] While the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** are all included with the drug administration device **1016** in this illustrated embodiment, as mentioned above one or more of the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** can be separate from the drug administration device **1016** by, e.g., being worn on the patient, being placed in a shared geographical space with the patient, being attached to other equipment or instruments, being part of a mobile phone app used by the patient, etc.

[0140] Changing the at least one variable parameter can result in an adjusted injection or flow rate speed of each provided dose, e.g., the at least one variable parameter can include injection or flow rate speed. Instead or in addition, a temperature of a drug can be varied to create constant flow, as discussed, for example, in U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2002/0042596 entitled “Method And Apparatus To Sense Temperature In An Implantable Pump” published Apr. 11, 2002, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

[0141] Injection site pain can be minimized in at least some embodiments by the drug administration device **1016** and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** monitoring patient usage, patient preferences, patient physical attributes, the one or more sensed characteristics associated with the patient, various parameters of the drug, etc. For example, patient factors such as weight, BMI, age, etc.; type of delivery mechanism of the drug, such as bolus injection delivery, continuous delivery, inhalation, etc.; a total number and history of injections at the desired location for injectable drugs; a volume of the drug; measured parameters about a status and state of the drug itself like viscosity, temperature, pH level; can all be used to anticipate the pain involved in administering the next drug administration, such as the next injection. Various delivery parameters of the drug, such as the speed, wait period, pressure, location recommendations, etc. can then be updated through the at least one variable parameter to minimize patient pain and discomfort.

[0142] In at least some embodiments, allowing the drug administration device **1016** and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** to have more situational awareness of the patient may facilitate compliance. The drug administration device **1016** can be used to increase compliance by a patient or medical personnel and/or increase familiarity with how the drug administration device **1016** operates in any number of different ways. For example, the drug administration device **1016** and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** can be configured to provide reminders, updates, adaptive training, etc. to the patient and/or medical personnel based on compliance data and/or compliance data that is stored on or pushed out to the drug administration device **1016** and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** to reinforce healthy behaviors, teach steps of use for the device, and other details. Increasing compliance and familiarity with the drug administration device **1016** can help reduce patient risk when being administered the drug, the importance of which is discussed, for example, in U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2015/0359966 entitled “System For Monitoring And Delivering Medication To A Patient And Method Of Using The Same To Minimize The Risks Associated With Automated Therapy” published Dec. 17, 2015, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

[0143] FIG. **12** illustrates an embodiment of use of the drug administration device **1016**. Prior to a first delivery of a dose of the drug, the drug administration device **1016** gathers data regarding the first characteristic associated with the patient using the first sensor **1030**, gathers data regarding the second characteristic using the second sensor **1040**, and gathers data regarding the third characteristic using the third sensor **1045**. Alternatively or in addition, a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** gathers data regarding the first characteristic using at least one external, separate sensor. The first delivery of the dose can be the initial dose delivered from the drug administration device **1016** to the patient, or it can be the first dose delivered from the drug administration device **1016** to the patient after at least one dose has already been provided to the patient and after a sufficient amount of data has been gathered via the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** and/or at least one external, separate sensor. Further data can optionally be gathered regarding additional characteristics associated with the patient by using additional secondary sensors. The data gathered represents pluralities of data points defining each characteristic and are stored in the memory **1050** and/or in the surgical hub's memory. The processor **1060** subsequently controls delivery of the first dose of the drug from the drug administration device **1016** to the patient by executing the algorithm **1052** stored in the memory

1050. The sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** and/or the at least one external, separate sensor continue gathering data. Based on any of this subsequently gathered data, the processor **1060** changes the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** as discussed above. After changing the at least one variable parameter, the processor **1060** controls delivery of at least the second dose from the drug administration device **1016** to the patient by executing the algorithm **1052**. The processor **1060** executing the algorithm **1052** to deliver a dose can be automatic, manual, or some combination of the two, and it can be according to a predetermined schedule of dosing, as discussed above.

[0144] During any part of the dosage process of FIG. **12**, the drug administration device **1016** can communicate with one or more computer systems, e.g., a local surgical hub, a remote server such as a cloud server, etc., using the communications interface **1099** to provide data thereto and/or receive instructions therefrom and/or can communicate with the user via the device indicator **1085** and/or the user interface **1080** to provide information thereto and/or receive instructions therefrom. In some embodiments, administering a first dose, a second dose, and/or any subsequent doses can be dependent on receiving instructions from a surgical hub and/or one or more remote computer systems. Furthermore, the second or any subsequent doses can also be prevented entirely based on changes to the variable parameter, thus resulting effectively in the second or subsequent dose being equivalent to zero drug being administered.

[0145] In at least some embodiments, the processor **1060** and/or a surgical hub (e.g., a processor thereof) is configured to use a hierarchy in terms of how data from the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** and/or at least one external, separate sensor is used compared to each other and/or to any additional sensors. The hierarchy prioritizes one of the sensors over the other(s) such that one acts as a primary sensor, such as sensor **1030**, and the other(s) act as secondary or ancillary sensor(s), such as sensors **1040**, **1045**. In such embodiments, the characteristic measured by the primary sensor can be considered to be the primary or defining characteristic, and characteristics measured by the secondary sensors can be secondary or influencing characteristics on the primary characteristic. This prioritization or hierarchy of characteristics (and thus data) can be helpful when the drug administration device **1016** is used for a treatment that includes one controlling characteristic and one or more secondary characteristics that may influence or assist in monitoring the controlling characteristic, for example when measuring blood pressure when administering blood pressure medication or when measuring blood sugar level when administering insulin. While secondary characteristics can help in monitoring high blood pressure or low blood sugar, the characteristics of primary concern in each example is blood pressure itself or blood sugar level itself. The prioritization of data and inputs from one or more secondary sensors based on the hierarchical relationship can be customizable based on desired patient outcomes, various expected or anticipated side-effects, the drug being administered, time of day, location, activity level, caloric intake, physical activity, etc. The drug administration device **1016** can thus have a predefined hierarchy of levels or severity of effect on dosage based on the sensed characteristics from the sensor(s). A medical professional or unlearned algorithm within the drug administration device **1016** itself and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device **1016** can optionally adjust the priority of the levels or reorder the importance of the various sensed data and inputs as a result of dosing amounts and/or dosing timelines, as discussed below. Because so much data can be generated by using a plurality of sensors and because data from one sensor may contradict data from another sensor in some instances, effectively using situational awareness to personalize drug administration to each patient may benefit from prioritization and relative weighing of multiple sources of information to arrive at a most correct conclusion or recommendation to best help the patient. This hierarchy of prioritization can be customized for a specific patient based on how the patient presents in any one moment or over time, therefore providing an adaptive device with re-orderable hierarchal relationships.

[0146] As mentioned above, the hierarchical arrangement can be used in a variety of ways, for

example to verify a physiological result such that data from one or more sensors is considered to adjust the at least one variable parameter to proactively manage any anticipated negative effect on the primary characteristic being measured. The hierarchy between various sensors can be predefined; can be adaptable based on user input, such as providing input through the user interface **1085**; can be adaptable based on a processor, an algorithm, any analyzed data, etc.; and/or can be adaptable through contact with remote computer systems, doctors, remote-care providers, etc.

[0147] In general, a primary characteristic for a drug administration device can be a control measure, and secondary characteristic(s) or measures can be data taken from sources surrounding the primary characteristic and/or sources that can influence and/or be influenced by the primary source. For example, blood sugar level is a primary characteristic for insulin delivery, but blood pressure is a primary characteristic for various blood pressure medications. Additionally, sources surrounding the primary source can take a variety of different forms, such as glucose level (for example, as measured by a micro needle application and/or sweat analysis); blood pressure (for example, as measured by various wearable cuffs); hydration (for example, as measured by perspiration level); heart rate and/or activity level (for example, as measured by various metabolic consumption rates, sitting or sedentary motion determined by elevation changes, various gyroscopes); EKG cycle; heart rate variability; various acute effects or activities to trigger measurement (such as sleep or sleep quality detection and/or meal detection, for example by analyzing one or more images of the patient, receiving input from the patient, etc.); discernment between eating and drinking; various long term effects to monitor any changes that might inform a new diagnoses or provide alerts to seek evaluation for any possible new conditions; core temperature; tremor detection; patient held/worn camera image analysis; time of day; digital calendar information; GPS outputs; device activity; any user interaction with the device; etc.

[0148] Additionally, numerous means for being aware of any surrounding situation during administration of the drug are possible, providing a variety of types of situational awareness that one or more drug administration devices can use. As further examples, forms of cognitive analysis can be performed on the patient by combining small interactions with the patient and various automated sensors on or around the patient to determine cognitive effects of any drug dosage on the patient. Various measured reactions to drug dosages can also be analyzed, such as timing to a first effect, effect duration, magnitude of effect, etc. Ending continued application of a drug can be one result, however there are many other examples where such an action can be taken. For example, if a biologic or drug is being delivered on an ongoing basis, the plurality of sensors can allow detection of an onset of a complex biologic response to the biologic or drug, and a drug administration device can have the ability to affect, retard, or end the continued application of the biologic or drug. Thus, drug administration devices and/or surgical hubs described herein can be configured to provide detection of and an automated response to collateral physiologic reactions to any continuous biologic introduction. For example, injection reactions can be an issue for some biologics, especially when delivered through an IV given delivery times and the continuous administration. Thus, drug administration devices and/or surgical hubs described herein can be configured to detect various onsets of injection reactions, such as through sensor(s), and consequently stop or slow down delivery of the drug. In at least some embodiments, drug administration devices described herein can be configured to deliver other medication(s) to stop, lessen, or counteract the drug injection reaction. As another example, cytokine release syndrome is a form of systemic inflammatory response syndrome that can arise from an adverse effect of some monoclonal antibody drugs, as well as adoptive T-cell therapies. Once a drug administration device, or other system in communication with the drug administration device, detects pro-and anti-inflammatory components above a predetermined threshold in a patient, the drug administration device can be configured to reduce or stop the introduction of the treatment. In such an example, the drug administration device and/or a surgical hub can also be configured to notify medical personnel or introduce a canceling agent to accelerate the reduction of the response. If the injection response is

great enough as defined by predefined criteria, the drug administration device can be configured to automatically escalate its response, or a surgical hub can be configured to cause the drug administration device to escalate its response, from a passive indication or reduction of dosage to a more active warning notification or introductions of other active countermeasures. Even when medical intervention is required, such as requiring a patient to go into a hospital for emergency treatment or altering a pre-operative plan during surgery, the drug administration devices and surgical hubs described herein can be configured to use biometric data to detect changes in the patient's body, such as body temperature or heart rate, that typically proceed a serious effect. The drug administration device and/or the surgical hub can be configured to notify the patient and/or medical personnel of the imminent effect to allow the patient and/or medical personnel to take preemptive action, such as taking medication at home before then going into the hospital before one or more major side effects take place, preparing another drug for delivery, etc. This early warning can improve patient outcomes by reducing any negative consequences.

[0149] In at least some implementations, drug delivery from a drug administration device is altered based on interaction between a drug administration device and an accessory, representing a cooperative or closed-loop relationship between the drug administration device and the accessory. The accessory can either be retained in or on the drug administration device or can be external to and separate therefrom. A surgical hub is one example of an accessory that is external to and separate from a drug administration device. The accessory includes a processor configured to receive data from at least one sensor of the drug administration device that is indicative of a patient's physiological characteristic and to control delivery of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient based on the received data. As such, dosages can be varied over time based on the sensor data and interaction with the accessory to allow for more personalized drug administration during each dose and over time, thus increasing the beneficial results of the drug by taking into consideration actual, present conditions of the patient. This functionality is similar to that discussed above with respect to FIGS. **11** and **12** except that the accessory, not the drug administration device, manages an algorithm controlling drug delivery from the drug administration device. The drug administration device may thus be less “smart” than the drug administration device **1016** of FIG. **11** and, consequently, be smaller and/or less expensive. Also, it is typically less expensive and/or easier for the patient to upgrade accessories, such as wearable accessories, and/or acquire new accessories than for the patient to upgrade the drug administration device or acquire a new drug administration device, so offloading processing and algorithm control to the accessory may extend the useful life of the drug administration device.

[0150] FIG. **13** illustrates one embodiment of a drug administration system **2000** including a universal drug administration device **2002** and an accessory **3002**. The drug administration device **2002** in this illustrated embodiment includes a housing **2004**, a drug holder **2010**, a dispensing mechanism **2020**, at least one sensor **2030**, **2040**, a memory **2050**, a processor **2060**, a user interface **2080**, an indicator **2085**, a power supply **2095**, and a communications interface **2099**. The accessory **3002** in this illustrated embodiment includes a housing **3004**, at least one sensor **3030**, a memory **3050** configured to store an algorithm **3052** therein, a user interface **3080**, a device indicator **3085**, a processor **3060**, a power supply **3095**, and a communications interface **3099**. Additionally, similar to that mentioned above, a person skilled in the art will appreciate that each of the universal drug administration device **2002** and the accessory **3002** can be provided with a variety of the features described above, in a number of different combinations.

[0151] First and second sensors **2030**, **2040** of the drug administration device **2002** are similar to the sensors **1030**, **1040**, **1045** of FIG. **11** discussed above. In an exemplary embodiment each sensor **2030**, **2040** is configured to gather data regarding a physiological characteristic of the patient. For example, the sensed physiological characteristics can be any two or more of a reaction of the patient to the drug delivered thereto, blood sugar level, blood pressure, perspiration level, heart rate, atmospheric sensing, angular rate, body orientation, MARG (magnetic, angular rate, and

gravity), internal device sensing, blood oxygenation level, sun exposure, osmolality, piezoelectric skin measurements such as ultrasonic response changes, electrical parameter of dermis such as impedance, biosensing, sensing an enzyme, sensing an antibody, sensing a histamine, sensing a nucleic acid, any of the characteristics discussed for device **10016** air quality tracking, etc. Alternatively or in addition one or both of the sensors **2030**, **2040** can be configured to gather data regarding a current of a motor used in delivering the drug. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2002/0014951 entitled "Remote Control For A Hospital Bed" published Feb. 7, 2002 and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2007/0251835 entitled "Subnetwork Synchronization And Variable Transmit Synchronization Techniques For A Wireless Medical Device Network" published Nov. 1, 2007 further discuss various sensors and are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties. The sensors **2030**, **2040** can either monitor the same physiological parameter or monitor different physiological parameters. Monitoring the same parameter may allow for confirmation of a condition, while monitoring different parameters may allow for more characteristics associated with the patient to be considered for drug delivery. While two sensors are illustrated in FIG. **13**, the device **2002** can include only one sensor, such as sensor **2030**, or can include three or more sensors. Any additional sensors can operate similarly to sensors **2030**, **2040** and can also monitor various physiological characteristics. One or both of the sensors **2030**, **2040** can be a biosensor, e.g., a device that includes a biological component and a transducer and that is configured to sense a biological element such as an enzyme, an antibody, a histamine, a nucleic acid, etc. The sensors **2030**, **2040** can operate together as a sensor array or a dual sensor. The sensors **2030**, **2040** are configured to sense their respective physiological characteristic(s), and the memory **2060** is configured to store therein data as pluralities of data points defining and/or representing the sensed characteristic(s). The communications interface **2099** is configured to communicate data indicative of the sensed information to the accessory **3002**, e.g., to the communications interface **3099** thereof to allow the received information to be stored in the memory **3050** and analyzed by the processor **3060** to control drug delivery from the device **2002** using the algorithm **3052**.

[0152] The accessory's at least one sensor **3030** is configured to sense one or more characteristics associated with a patient. The one or more characteristics can be physiological characteristics and/or situational characteristics of the patient. Various different physiological characteristics can be monitored, such as heart rate, blood pressure, perspiration level, etc. A number of different situational characteristics can be monitored, such as core temperature, time of day, date, patient activity level, altitude, GPS information, blood oxygenation level, sun exposure, osmolality, air quality, inflammatory response, one or more images and/or videos of the patient and/or an environment in which the patient is located (for example, to analyze food intake, to determine whether solid food or liquid is being consumed, to determine a location or activity of the patient, to determine a condition of the patient such as skin reaction, etc.), user-input data such as general well-being or a cycle time between flare ups of a particular ailment, etc. The at least one sensor **3030** is configured to sense the characteristic(s), with the memory **3050** storing gathered data as pluralities of data points defining and/or representing the sensed characteristic(s).

[0153] In at least some embodiments, one of the sensors **2030**, **2040** of the drug administration device **2002** can in effect act as a primary sensor for the administration system **2000** that defines an operational range of closed loop control of the drug dosage and timing administration, and the at least one sensor **3030** of the accessory **3002** can act as a secondary sensor that provides patient feedback and is used to adjust the dosage amount, dosage timing, dosage location, etc. within the range defined by the primary sensor **2030**. In other embodiments, the at least one sensor **3030** of the accessory **3002** can act as the primary sensor, and one of the sensors **2030**, **2040** of the drug administration device **2002** can in effect act as the secondary sensor.

[0154] The processor **3060** of the accessory **3002** is configured to control delivery of the drug from the drug administration device **2002** to a patient based on the sensed data received from the device **2002** and, in at least some embodiments, additionally or alternatively based on data gathered by the

accessory's at least one sensor **3030**. Similar to that discussed above, the processor **3060** is configured to control the drug delivery by changing at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **3052** such as adjusting at least one variable parameter for a dosage of the drug, a timing between doses of the drug, a location of delivery of the drug, a concentration of the dose, actuating a set number or a continuous number of discrete doses, actuating continuous dosage, actuating an initial bolus dose and then subsequent sporadic or repeating smaller doses as needed, terminating dosage, skipping one or more doses, etc. The data received at the accessory **3002** from the device **2002** is in the form of pluralities of data points defining the sensed physiological characteristic(s) data of the patient. The processor **3060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **3052** during the delivery of a dose such that the algorithm **3052** is changed in real time with the delivery of the dose (e.g., in real time with execution of the algorithm) and/or in real time with use of the drug administration device **1016** during performance of a surgical procedure, which may accommodate real time sensed conditions. The processor **3060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **3052** before a start of the delivery of the dose, which may consume less memory and use fewer processing resources during algorithm **3052** execution than real time changing of the algorithm **3052**.

[0155] The processor **3060** is configured to control drug delivery from the device **2002** through any of a variety of different mechanisms, such as by transmitting a command to the device **2002** using the communications interfaces **2099**, **3099** with the device's processor **2060** executing the command to cause drug delivery (e.g., by providing a plurality of data points defining one or more instructions to the device **2002**). Instead of the algorithm **3052** being stored at the accessory **3002**, the algorithm for controlling drug delivery from the device **2002** can be stored at the device **2002**, e.g., in the memory **2050** thereof. Similar to that discussed above, the accessory **3002** can be configured to cause at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored at the device **2002** to be changed based on the data gathered by the device's at least one sensor **2030**, **2040** and/or based on the data gathered by the accessory's at least one sensor **3030**, e.g., by transmitting a command to the device **2002** using the communications interfaces **2099**, **3099** with the device's processor **3060** executing the command to change the at least one variable parameter as instructed. The algorithm being stored at the device **2002** instead of the accessory **3002** may help ensure that drug delivery occurs since delivery is controlled locally and can occur even if communication is broken between the device **2002** and accessory **3002**, e.g., because the device **2002** and accessory **3002** are out of wireless communication range of one another, because of a network system problem, because of power loss at the accessory **3002**, etc.

[0156] FIG. **14** illustrates an embodiment of use of the drug administration device **2002** and accessory **3002**. The use is similar to that discussed above with respect to FIG. **12** except that the processor **3050** of the accessory **3002** is shown as being involved in data analysis and control of dose delivery.

[0157] Various delivery types can be used from the drug administration device **2002**, such as bolus or basal deliveries. For example, based on the severity of a hyper- or hypoglycemic reaction, a large bolus delivery can be used to prevent a body of a patient from further degrading. For another example, an automated system can adjust basal insulin target dose sizes based on a long term tracking of blood sugar, continuously adjust around a target basal level based on continuous monitoring, and then introduce bolus levels only for severe adjustments.

[0158] In at least some embodiments, the drug administration device **2002** is a smart drug administration device that performs some analysis on its own, with the accessory **3002** providing additional smart functionality to help improve dosage effectiveness, safety, and/or accuracy. For example, a smart drug administration device can be a smart insulin pump, such as Medtronic's MiniMed 670G, that allows for blood sugar detection such that the pump tracks a patient's continuous glucose level while adjusting for proximity between pump and sensor. For another example, a smart drug administration device can be a glucagon delivery device that treats

hypoglycemia severity (defined by a blood sugar under **70**) by injecting glucagon to raise glucose leveled to the desired basal level. For yet another example, a smart drug administration device can be an insulin delivery device that continuously adjusts an amount of insulin it delivers from one minute to the next based upon readings from the continuous glucose monitor.

[0159] The accessory **3002** can take a variety of different forms. The accessory **3002** can be used solely for helping to control drug delivery from the drug administration device **2002**. Alternatively, the accessory **3002** can have an additional purpose that is different than that of drug delivery from the drug administration device **2002** and thus be multi-functional, for example as with the surgical hub.

[0160] Embodiments of accessories include surgical hubs, ear wigs, ear pieces, smart watches, fingernail sensors, digital collection patches (with or without direct skin contact), augmented reality or smart glasses, implantable or ingestible components, headbands, digitally connected devices to communicate weight, worn cameras (such as in smart glasses), carried cameras (such as in smartphones, mobile tablets, etc.), handheld diabetes management devices, smart mobility aid devices, tracking and monitoring mechanisms, etc. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2014/0081659 entitled “Systems And Methods For Surgical And Interventional Planning, Support, Post-Operative Follow-Up, And Functional Recovery Tracking” published Mar. 20, 2014 further describes various embodiments of tracking and monitoring mechanisms and is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2012/0095318 entitled “Handheld Diabetes Management Device With Bolus Calculator” published Apr. 19, 2012, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety, further describes embodiments of handheld diabetes management devices. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2017/0172462 entitled “Multi-Functional Smart Mobility Aid Devices And Methods Of Use” filed on Jun. 22, 2017, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety, further describes embodiments of smart mobility aid devices.

[0161] As mentioned above, image analysis can be used for capturing data in the environment around the patient, whether the patient is or is not in a surgical setting. For example, as will be appreciated by a person skilled in the art, image analysis can be used for meal detection, such as for confirmation that a meal is occurring; analysis of a meal itself such as volume or carbohydrate, protein, and fat content; image analysis of skin tone, injection site, and/or other anatomic structure to determine redness, inflammation, and/or other reaction; calculation of dosage amounts for drugs that are administered based on body area (for example, mg/m²) such that images of the body of a patient can be used to calculate a dose in addition to any patient inputs such as weight, age, etc.; image analysis to provide relevant drug information through an interconnection between an image taken by a patient and any smart digital patient device that would allow the device to provide user information on the medication, dosage, timing, function, etc. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2012/0330684 entitled “Medication Verification And Dispensing” published Dec. 27, 2012, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety, further describes image capturing devices. In response to detecting a meal, the accessory can be configured to adjust drug delivery from the drug administration device in communication with the accessory.

[0162] FIG. 15 illustrates an embodiment of an accessory **5000** in the form of smart glasses with a camera **5002** built therein. A user **4000** can wear the accessory **5000** like a normal pair of glasses, however the accessory **5000**, e.g., a processor thereof, is configured to analyze images captured by the camera **5002** to visually identify a variety of types of information about a meal **5004** and/or a drink **5006** that the user **4000** is consuming, such as food type, food amount, amount of food remaining on plate, etc. U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2011/0295337 entitled “Systems and Methods For Regulating Metabolic Hormone Producing Tissue” filed on Dec. 1, 2011, U.S. Pat. No. 8,696,616 entitled “Obesity Therapy And Heart Rate Variability” issued Apr. 15, 2014, U.S. Pat. No. 9,427,580 entitled “Devices And Methods For The Treatment Of Metabolic Disorders” issued Aug. 30, 2016, and U.S. Pat. No. 9,168,000 entitled “Meal Detection Devices And Methods” issued Oct. 27, 2015, which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties, further describe identifying

types of information about a meal and/or a drink. Detecting occurrences of eating/drinking with certainty is important for safety, efficacy, and cost, and can be combined with sensed information through situational awareness, as discussed above regarding the drug administration device **1016**, to increase the accuracy of meal detection methods described herein. Images captured by the camera **5002** can be used to visually identify types of information and not in the meal **5004** and/or the drink **5006** context shown in FIG. **15**, as mentioned above, such as for analysis of skin tone, injection site, and/or other anatomic structure to determine redness, inflammation, and/or other reaction.

[0163] As mentioned above, different sensor configurations and interactions can be used to produce primary and secondary measurements of physiological characteristic(s) of the patient, both in the drug administration device and/or the accessory. For example, sensors used can be modular sensor arrays, configurable sensor arrays, dual sensors that provide interactive sensing, dual cooperative remote sensing arrays, etc. In such examples, one or more sensor(s) configured to detect a physiologic response to drug administration in the patient can be positioned remotely to an injection site to prevent drug administration itself from interfering with the result. In addition, a second sensor array can be positioned close to the injection site and/or the drug administration device in order to determine acute local reaction and verify that the drug administration device has operated correctly.

[0164] FIGS. **16** and **18** illustrate an embodiment of an accessory **5010** including a camera configured to gather images of the skin of a patient **4000** at various points on the patient's body. The accessory **5010** (and/or a computer system, such as a surgical hub, in communication with the accessory **5010**) is configured to monitor the patient's skin tone, either at a single point or, as illustrated in FIG. **17** (for analysis of data gathered as shown in FIG. **16**) and FIG. **19** (for analysis of data gathered as shown in FIG. **18**), over time to track any possible reactions to a drug and/or to watch for any inflammation (either caused by administration of the drug or caused by a secondary source and for which the drug is being administered to treat) and, in response to detecting a drug reaction and/or inflammation, adjust drug delivery from the drug administration device in communication with the accessory **5010** (and/or the computer system). FIGS. **17** and **19** illustrate times t.sub.1, t.sub.2, t.sub.3, t.sub.4, t.sub.5, and t.sub.6 and a corresponding photo color chart of the patient's skin tone at each point in time (shown in grayscale in FIGS. **17** and **19**). The broken lines traced on the graphs in FIGS. **17** and **19** represent slight inflammation and severe inflammation such that image analysis (either electronically by the system or manually by a care professional) allows tracking of inflammation and alerts, notification, pre-emptive action, responsive action, etc. in response to skin tone passing over the slight and/or the severe inflammation. FIG. **16** illustrates taking images at random points **5012** on the patient **4000**. FIG. **18** illustrates taking images of the patient's face **5014** and at the point of administration of the drug in the form of an IV port **5016**. The point of administration and the face **5014** of the patient **4000** can be useful areas to monitor for any adverse or beneficial reactions to an administered drug because the site of administration (the IV port **5016**) is the first point of contact between the drug and the patient **4000** and human faces can be expressive of possible adverse reactions such as allergic reactions, etc.

[0165] Although FIGS. **16** and **18** show the camera as being part of a smartphone, the accessory configured to gather images can be a device other than a smartphone, such as an endoscope or other scoping device, a mobile tablet, a smartwatch, etc. Additionally, although the same accessory **5010** is shown gathering the images in FIGS. **16** and **18**, two different accessories can gather the data of FIGS. **16** and **18**.

[0166] In at least some implementations, drug delivery from a drug administration device is altered based on an awareness of a status of a patient, such as altering drug delivery based on at least one physiological characteristic of the patient and on at least one related physical characteristic of the patient. These implementations are similar to those discussed above with respect to drug delivery

being altered based on one or more characteristics associated with the patient that are determined based on situational awareness of the patient except that the characteristics associated with the patient are determined based on at least one physiological characteristic of the patient and on at least one related physical characteristic of the patient. The implementations that take into account physiological characteristic(s) and physical characteristic(s) allow dosages to be varied based on a status of the patient, represented by the physiological and physical characteristics of the patient, to allow for personalized care, an adaptive drug administration process to improve patient care, and/or automatic dose adjustment to increase successful drug use. Various different physiological characteristics of the patient can be monitored, such as body temperature, heart rate, blood sugar level, blood pressure, perspiration level, etc. Various different physical characteristics of the patient can be monitored, such as temperature, metabolic demand, cognitive function, metabolic demand such as measured using at least one of food intake and BMR (basal metabolic rate), weight, one or more images and/or videos of the patient and/or an environment in which the patient is located (for example, to analyze food intake, to determine whether solid food or liquid is being consumed, to determine a location or activity of the patient, to determine a condition of the patient such as skin reaction, etc.), etc. Various different physical characteristics of the patient's environment can be monitored, such as atmospheric contaminant percentage, environmental temperature, etc.

[0167] Using the universal drug administration device **500** of FIG. **5** by way of example, the memory **97** can have stored therein the algorithm executable to administer a dose of drug to a patient, and the processor **96** can be configured to execute the algorithm to control delivery of a dose of the drug dispensed by the dispensing mechanism **20**. The processor **96** can also be configured to use physiological data representative of at least one physiological characteristic of the patient and physical data representative of at least one physical characteristic of the patient to change at least one variable parameter of the algorithm such that a dose delivered subsequent to the changing of the at least one variable parameter will be controlled by execution of the changed algorithm. As mentioned above, a person skilled in the art will appreciate that the universal drug administration device **500** can be provided with a variety of the optional features described above, in a number of different combinations, e.g., not include any of the sensors **92, 94, 98** not being used by the processor **96** to change variable parameter(s) of the algorithm (and instead include sensor(s) to gather the needed physical and physiological characteristic data), not include packaging **35**, not include user interface **80**, etc. The processor **96** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm during the delivery of a dose such that the algorithm is changed in real time with the delivery of the dose (e.g., in real time with execution of the algorithm) and/or in real time with use of the drug administration device **500** during performance of a surgical procedure, which may accommodate real time sensed conditions, or the processor **96** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm before a start of the delivery of the dose, which may consume less memory and use fewer processing resources during algorithm execution than real time changing of the algorithm.

[0168] Using the universal drug administration device **1016** of FIG. **11** by way of another example, the use is similar to that discussed above regarding FIG. **5**. The memory **1050** has stored therein the algorithm **1052**, and the processor **1060** is configured to execute the algorithm **1052** to control delivery of a dose of the drug dispensed by the dispensing mechanism **1020**. The processor **1060** is also configured to use physical characteristic data and physiological characteristic data gathered by at least two of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** and/or at least one external, separate sensor to change at least one variable parameter of the algorithm **1052** such that a dose delivered subsequent to the changing of the at least one variable parameter will be controlled by execution of the changed algorithm **1052**. As mentioned above, a person skilled in the art will appreciate that the universal drug administration device **1016** can be provided with a variety of the optional features described above, in a number of different combinations, e.g., not include any of the sensors **1030, 1040, 1045** not being used by the processor **1060** to change variable parameter(s) of the algorithm **1052** (and

instead include sensor(s) to gather the needed physical and physiological characteristic data), not include user interface **1080**, etc. The processor **1060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm during the delivery of a dose such that the algorithm is changed in real time with the delivery of the dose (e.g., in real time with execution of the algorithm) and/or in real time with use of the drug administration device **1016** during performance of a surgical procedure, which may accommodate real time sensed conditions, or the processor **1060** can be configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm before a start of the delivery of the dose, which may consume less memory and use fewer processing resources during algorithm execution than real time changing of the algorithm.

[0169] In at least some embodiments, the at least one physiologic characteristic is directly tied to the treatment being administered by the drug administration device, and the drug administration device and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device is configured to use local or immediate processing to determine and adjust dosage to compensate for or overcome one or more current physical characteristic(s) being sensed. In such embodiments, as discussed herein, the at least one physiological characteristic is the primary characteristic that defines a range of responses of the drug administration device and the at least one variable parameter, and the one or more physical characteristics are secondary characteristics used to fine-tune or influence the drug administration device's dosage by changing the at least one variable parameter.

[0170] The implementations in which drug delivery from a drug administration device is altered based on an awareness of a status of a patient may allow for detection of any number of physiological and/or physical characteristics. For example, detection of a physical characteristic of activity level, metabolism, and/or metabolic level can influence adjustment of dosage based on increased physiological demand. Generally, metabolism and metabolic rates are a blend between total energy expenditure and the energy balance between caloric intake and loss. Precise measurements of activity, caloric intake, fecal caloric output, oxygen consumption/ CO_2 generation, etc. can thus be used to inform metabolic activity. In such embodiments, metabolic activity can be the measured physiological characteristic, and one or more physical characteristics, such as activity, caloric intake, fecal caloric output, oxygen consumption/ CO_2 generation, etc. can be measured to guide adjustment of drug administration based on the measured physiological characteristic. In other embodiments, a combination of a variety of different measurements, such as activity measures, food intake measures, BMR, a physiologic measure such as body temperature or change in temperature, environmental temperature, and/or heart rate can be used as various approximations for real-time metabolic rates of a patient rather than attempting a more direct measurement. Metabolic rates are further discussed in, for example, Lam YY and Ravussin, E., "Analysis of energy metabolism in humans: A review of methodologies," *Mol Metab.* 2016 November; 5(11): 1057-1071 (available at <<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC5081410/>>), which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

[0171] Drug delivery adjustment in implementations in which drug delivery from a drug administration device is altered based on an awareness of a status of a patient can be fully automatic, partially automatic and partially manual, or fully manual. Some degree of automatic dosage adjustment can be especially beneficial in situations when patients may have difficulty applying any recommended changes themselves caused by various patient circumstances, environmental cues, and/or physiological cues. For example, patient capacity and/or competency levels can be used as one or more means to determine between a fully automated response by the drug administration device and/or varying degrees of user partial control over dosage adjustment. For example, patients may normally be able to interact with the drug administration device(s) safely, but during various emergency situations, the patient's abilities may be impaired and automatic action may be required. Some degree of automatic dosage adjustment can be especially beneficial during performance of a surgical procedure on a patient when surgical personnel is

handling multiple different tasks including monitoring and/or actuating drug delivery and when multiple characteristics of the patient are being monitored. The surgical personnel may therefore have difficulty applying any recommended changes themselves caused by various patient circumstances, environmental cues, and/or physiological cues. For example, one or more drugs may be planned pre-operatively for delivery to the patient at certain point(s) during performance of the surgical procedure, so allowing for automatic drug delivery from the drug administration device(s) may facilitate accurate execution of the pre-operative plan. For example, surgical personnel may normally be able to interact with the drug administration device(s) safely, but during various emergency situations, their abilities may be impaired and automatic action may be required.

[0172] Thus, drug administration devices in at least some embodiments herein can be partially automatic, allowing patient and/or doctor (or other medical personnel) control or override of automatic actions in various situations while providing automatic actions that cannot be overridden by a patient and/or doctor (or other medical personnel) in various emergency situations. The notifications in at least some embodiments can have priorities or degrees to them, becoming more insistent as a situation becomes more dangerous for the patient. With certain drug administration devices, care providers, surgical personnel, and/or emergency personnel may be automatically alerted when certain major alarms are sounded. Additionally, risk-based assessments of treatment can become more aggressive over time if a patient fails to take appropriate de-escalation actions and/or the drug administration device detects an apparent lack of patient ability to help themselves.

[0173] A variety of other patient circumstances may lend themselves to some degree of partial or full automation for dosage adjustments. For example, a pediatric patient may not yet understand or be able to manipulate the drug administration device in a safe way, the patient may suffer from dementia while having a disease requiring an injectable or oral medication and cannot understand the drug administration device, patients may suffer from various mental or psychiatric disorders that affect their ability to use the drug administration device and/or to perceive gradual symptom escalation, patients may have a hard time administering the drug and need to rely on automatic actions by the drug administration device, etc. In at least some situations, recommended treatments can allow for drug administration device adjustments that simply make more sense to automate to help with compliance, such as with injectables that may be various forms of pumps or other drug administration devices almost always worn by a patient. For example, various diabetes side effects can increase a difficulty or inhibit a patient's ability to administer an adjusted dosage due to age, dexterity, onset of various complicating situations (such as hyper- or hypoglycemia), etc.

[0174] Similar to the accessory discussed above, at least some embodiments of drug administration devices can be configured to automatically adjust dosage over time based on a patient's weight, such as for a pediatric patient since weight tends to fluctuate more for pediatric patients as they are in the process of growing. Weight measurements can be taken in a variety of ways, such as from a scale in the home that automatically communicates the measured weight to the drug administration device or by analyzing images as discussed above. Warnings of weight change can also be provided prior to any change to a dosage actually occurring. In some situations, independent verification and/or approval by a patient's care provider may be required before initiating any change. For example, parents and/or doctors can report a pediatric patient's weight when possible, and the dosing algorithm for the patient can then update automatically with the new weight information. Any changes can be made directly on the drug administration device and/or can be made remotely.

[0175] In at least some embodiments in which drug delivery from a drug administration device is altered based on an awareness of a status of a patient, such as altering drug delivery based on at least one physiological characteristic of the patient and on at least one related physical characteristic of the patient, situational awareness of the patient can also be considered in altering the drug delivery, similar to that discussed above, for example, with respect to the drug administration device **1016** of FIG. **11**. For example, additionally taking into account situational

awareness can allow a drug administration device and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device to refine sensed data, mitigate errors, eliminate or reduce inaccurate outliers, and/or otherwise selectively affect the drug administration device to improve the device's understanding of the physiological reactions of the patient leading up to or after a dosage administration. Thus, one or more sensors can act as adaptive sensing arrays based on a situational awareness of the patient and/or the drug administration device.

[0176] FIG. **20** illustrates an embodiment of an adverse reaction to a drug administration device in the form of an infusion device that delivers a dosage of a drug to a patient at time $t_{sub.1}$. Along with various physiological characteristic(s) of the patient and physical characteristic(s) of the patient that the drug administration device tracks to determine appropriate dosages of the drug, the drug administration device and/or a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device also monitors for an allergic reaction to the drug by the patient by measuring physical characteristics and physiological characteristics that can indicate an adverse reaction, such as heart rate variability, perspiration, and/or pupil dilation. At time $t_{sub.2}$, heart rate variability, perspiration, and pupil dilation all increase measurably, crossing over minor warning thresholds as illustrated and suggesting a possible adverse reaction to the drug. Thus, at time $t_{sub.3}$, the dosage of the drug is reduced and a bolus of a medication, e.g., Benadryl, is administered by the device at a lower dosage to counteract the patient reaction. At time $t_{sub.4}$, heart rate variability, perspiration, and pupil dilation all continue to increase, and heart rate variability and perspiration both cross over major warning thresholds. The drug administration device thus delivers a second larger bolus of the medication, at which point heart rate variability, perspiration, and pupil dilation all begin to decrease to more normal or baseline values. At this point in time, the patient's reaction is under control, so the original drug can continue to be delivered at the reduced dosage.

[0177] If the patient does not react effectively to drug administration, dosages of the original drug can be terminated entirely and restated at lower, stepped values only once the various symptoms of the adverse reaction have abated. For example, FIG. **21** illustrates a graph similar to the graph of FIG. **20** and shows measured blood pressure, temperature, and pupil dilation. At time $t_{sub.1}$, a dosage of the drug begins to be administered to the patient. At time $t_{sub.2}$, temperature and pupil dilation cross warning thresholds to indicate a possible adverse reaction, and the dosage is reduced. At time $t_{sub.3}$, a dose of the medication is administered because blood pressure has gone down but both temperature and pupil dilation have continued to increase. At time $t_{sub.4}$, pupil dilation is still elevated while temperature has crossed over a major threshold and blood pressure has decreased to such an extent that it has crossed over a lower threshold and is now too low. As such, drug dosage is stopped entirely. At $t_{sub.5}$, the blood pressure, temperature, and pupil dilation have begun to return to normal levels, so the drug is again administered to the patient. However, the dosage is further reduced. At time $t_{sub.6}$ when there has not been a significant increase in adverse reaction indications from the blood pressure, temperature, and pupil dilation, the dosage is again increased slightly and maintained at a lower level for the time being.

[0178] In at least some embodiments, patients and/or medical personnel can choose or opt in to monitoring from one or more sensors in a drug administration device and/or one or more external, separate sensors. For example, FIG. **22** illustrates one embodiment of a user interface **8080** of a drug administration device that allows a patient, either on the device itself or via other means such as a patient app associated with the device, to opt into monitoring using one or more sensors. In other embodiments, the user interface **8080** can instead or additionally be provided elsewhere, such as on a user interface of a surgical hub in communication with the drug administration device.

[0179] As the one or more sensors monitor the patient as shown in FIG. **23**, the one or more sensors can detect possible or likely early onset of joint pain, such as at $t_{sub.1}$ and $t_{sub.2}$. For example, a minor warning might be prompted at time $t_{sub.1}$ when readings from an activity level sensor and a gait analysis sensor indicate that physical activity may be too much for the patient and continued activity will prompt joint pain. As the patient continues activity, time point A on FIG. **23** indicates

crossing over a major threshold for heart rate variability, time point B indicates crossing over a major threshold for perspiration, and time point C indicates crossing over a major threshold for activity level, at which point an alert is sounded when all three conditions A, B, C are met at time t.sub.2 to indicate possible onset of severe joint pain. At this point, the drug administration device, a patient app, and/or the surgical hub can prompt the patient and/or other user to enter a pain score, for example by using the user interface **8080**, so that the drug administration device and any treating care provider can be better informed of the results of treatment. The situational awareness measurements discussed herein can be incorporated into any of the drug administration devices above to provide increased understanding of treatments and results and increased personalization of care.

[0180] As discussed above, some form of food intake and/or meal detection can be important when providing recommendations to a patient and when adjusting dosages. While some exemplary meal detection approaches are discussed above, such as image analysis, various drug administration devices can also use combinations of inputs from various physiological and/or physical sensors to confirm that a meal event has occurred and that it is significant enough to trigger a desired response in the patient. For example, analysis of heart rate variability (HRV), image analysis, gastric pH, a LINX Reflux Management device, etc. can each be used independently or in some combination to provide a more accurate detection of meal consumption. Providing various redundant measures may help minimize errors in meal detection.

[0181] Devices and systems disclosed herein can be designed to be disposed of after a single use, or they can be designed to be used multiple times. In either case, however, the devices can be reconditioned for reuse after at least one use. Reconditioning can include any combination of the steps of disassembly of the devices, followed by cleaning or replacement of particular pieces, and subsequent reassembly. In particular, the devices can be disassembled, and any number of the particular pieces or parts of the device can be selectively replaced or removed in any combination. Upon cleaning and/or replacement of particular parts, the devices can be reassembled for subsequent use either at a reconditioning facility, or by a surgical team immediately prior to a surgical procedure. Those skilled in the art will appreciate that reconditioning of a device can utilize a variety of techniques for disassembly, cleaning/replacement, and reassembly. Use of such techniques, and the resulting reconditioned device, are all within the scope of the present application.

[0182] It can be preferred that devices disclosed herein be sterilized before use. This can be done by any number of ways known to those skilled in the art including beta or gamma radiation, ethylene oxide, steam, and a liquid bath (e.g., cold soak). An exemplary embodiment of sterilizing a device including internal circuitry is described in more detail in U.S. Pat. No. 8,114,345 issued Feb. 14, 2012 and entitled "System And Method Of Sterilizing An Implantable Medical Device." It is preferred that device, if implanted, is hermetically sealed. This can be done by any number of ways known to those skilled in the art.

[0183] The present disclosure has been described above by way of example only within the context of the overall disclosure provided herein. It will be appreciated that modifications within the spirit and scope of the claims may be made without departing from the overall scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A surgical system, comprising: a drug administration device configured to deliver a drug to a patient during performance of a surgical procedure on the patient; a first sensor configured to gather data, during the performance of the surgical procedure, regarding a first characteristic associated with a patient; a memory configured to store therein an algorithm including at least one variable parameter; and a processor configured to: control delivery of a first dose of the drug from

the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm, change, during the performance of the surgical procedure, the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory based on the data gathered by the first sensor, and after changing the at least one variable parameter, control delivery of a second dose of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm; wherein the drug administration device includes the processor and the memory.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the drug administration device includes the first sensor.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the first sensor is external to and separate from the drug administration device.

4. The system of claim 1, further comprising a second sensor configured to gather data, during the performance of the surgical procedure, regarding a second, different characteristic associated with the patient; wherein the processor is configured to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory also based on the data gathered by the second sensor.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein the first characteristic is a physiological characteristic of the patient; and the second characteristic is a situational characteristic of the patient.

6. The system of claim 4, wherein the processor is also configured to consider the data gathered by each of the first and second sensors in a hierarchy in changing the at least one variable parameter.

7. The system of claim 6, wherein the drug administration device includes the first sensor; the second sensor is external to and separate from the drug administration device; a surgical hub includes a second processor; and the surgical hub is configured to be in communication with the drug administration device during the performance of the surgical procedure, thereby allowing the surgical hub to communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory.

8. (canceled)

9. The system of claim 1, further comprising a second processor, a surgical hub including the second processor; wherein the surgical hub is configured to; be in communication with the drug administration device during the performance of the surgical procedure, thereby allowing the surgical hub to communicate an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory, determine using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, and based on the data gathered by the first sensor, that the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory should be changed, and cause, using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, an instruction to be communicated to the drug administration device instructing the drug administration device to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory.

10. (canceled)

11. The system of claim 9, wherein the drug administration device is configured to change the at least one variable parameter only after the drug administration device receives the instruction.

12. The system of claim 1, wherein the first characteristic is at least one of a physiological characteristic of the patient and a situational characteristic of the patient.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the first characteristic is at least one of blood sugar level, blood pressure, perspiration level, heart rate, core temperature, tremor detection, time of day, date, patient activity level, blood pressure, metabolic rate, altitude, temperature of the drug, viscosity of the drug, GPS information, angular rate, current of a motor used in delivering the drug, blood oxygenation level, sun exposure, osmolality, and air quality.

14. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one variable parameter includes a rate of delivery of the drug from the drug administration device to the patient.

15. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one variable parameter includes a time interval between dose deliveries such that doses delivered after the changing of the at least one variable parameter are at a different time interval than doses delivered before the changing of the at least

one variable parameter.

16. The system of claim 1, wherein changing the at least one variable parameter results in the processor controlling delivery of the second dose such that the second dose is not delivered to the patient.

17. The system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to automatically change the at least one variable parameter.

18. A surgical method, comprising: gathering data, using a first sensor, regarding a first characteristic associated with a patient during performance of a surgical procedure on the patient; and using a processor of a drug administration device: controlling delivery of a first dose of a drug from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing an algorithm stored in a memory of the drug administration device, changing, during the performance of the surgical procedure, at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory based on the data gathered by the first sensor, and after changing the at least one variable parameter, controlling delivery of a second dose from the drug administration device to the patient, during the performance of the surgical procedure, by executing the algorithm.

19. The method of claim 18, further comprising gathering data, using a second sensor, regarding a second, different characteristic associated with the patient; wherein the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory is changed also based on the data gathered by the second sensor.

20. The method of claim 18, wherein the method further comprises: a surgical hub communicating, using a second processor of the surgical hub, during the performance of the surgical procedure, an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory, the surgical hub determining, using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, and based on the data gathered by the first sensor, that the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory should be changed, and the surgical hub causing, using the second processor, during the performance of the surgical procedure, an instruction to be communicated to the drug administration device instructing the drug administration device to change the at least one variable parameter of the algorithm stored in the memory.

21. The method of claim 18, the method further comprises the surgical hub communicating an instruction to the drug administration device to change the at least one variable stored in the memory.

22. The method of claim 18, wherein the first characteristic is at least one of a physiological characteristic of the patient and a situational characteristic of the patient.
